ZIKSHARE LIBRARY
ROMAN THEATRE

PLAUTUS

The Three Pieces of Money

Playwright	Plautus
Translated by	Henry Thomas Riley
Source text	Perseus Digital Library, phi0119.phi019.perseus-eng2
Edition	The Comedies of Plautus, literally translated (Bohn; Bell, 1912)
Language	English
Rights	Public domain

This PDF was typeset by ZikShare from the edition named above.
The play is in the public domain and ZikShare charges nothing for it.
The digital text is Perseus's TEI encoding of Riley, published under CC BY-SA 4.0;
the translation underneath it is public domain and is reproduced here unaltered.
Plautus' most moralising comedy, and the one that most clearly argues a case: what a man owes his friend. The three pieces of money are the fee paid to a sharper to impersonate a messenger.

Text: Plautus, The Comedies of Plautus, literally translated (Bohn; Bell, 1912).
Digital edition: Perseus Digital Library (TEI, CC BY-SA 4.0). The translation is public domain.
Riley's notes are collected at the end of this text.

Dramatis Personae

IN THE PROLOGUE.

LUXURY.
POVERTY.

IN THE PLAY.

CHARMIDES, an Athenian merchant.
LESBONICUS, the son of Charmides.
CALLICLES, a friend of Charmides.
MEGARONIDES, a friend of Callicles.
STASIMUS, the servant of Charmides and Lesbonicus.
PHILTO, a wealthy Athenian,
LYSITELES, the son of Philto, and a friend of Lesbonicus.
A SHARPER.

((Scene—A Street in Athens : the house of CHARMIDES on one side, and that of PHILTO on the other.))

THE SUBJECT.
CHARMIDES, a wealthy Athenian, his property having been much duninished by the reckless conduct of his son, goes abroad. His dissolute son, Lesbonicus, being left behind at Athens, consumes the little resources left him, and then puts up his father’s house for sale. At his departure, Charmides has entrusted his interests and the care of his son and daughter to his friend Callicles and has also informed him that in his house there is a treasure buried as a reserve against future contingencies. In order that this may not be lost, Cailicles buys the house of Lesbonicus for a small sum. Ignorant of his reason for doing so, his fellow-citizens censure him for his conduct, and accuse him of a breach of good faith in ministering to the extravagance of Lesbonicus by supplying him with money. For this reason Megaronides expostulates with his friend Callicles, and greatly censures him; on which, Callicles, in self-defence, entrusts him with the secret of the treasure. Charmides having left behind him a grown-up daughter in the care of Callicles, Lysiteles, a young man of rank and character, falls in love with her, and through his father, Philto, asks her in marriage. Her brother, Lesbonicus, is not averse to the match, but refuses to let her marry without giving her a portion; and he offers her to Lysiteles, on condition that he will receive as her marriage-portion a piece of land near the city, the sole remnant of his fortune. This, however, Lysiteles refuses to accept. In the mean time, Callicles, at the suggestion of Megaronides, determines to give the young woman a dowry out of the treasure buried in the house which he has bought; but that Lesbonicus may not suspect whence the money really comes, a Sharper is hired, with instructions to pretend that he brings letters from Charmides with a thousand gold pieces as a portion for his daughter when she should marry. It happens, that while the Sharper is on his way with his pretended errand to the abode of Callicles, Charmides, having unexpectedly returned to Athens, is going towards his house. He meets the Sharper, who discloses his errand and attempts to impose upon Charmides, who thereupon discovers himself Charmides then meets his servant Stasimus, who tells him of the purchase of his house by Callicles, whereon he conceives himself to have been betrayed by his friend. Afterwards, on discovering the truth, he praises the fidelity of Callicles, and bestows his daughter on Lysiteles, with a portion of a thousand gold pieces, and, at the intercession of Lysiteles, he forgives his son Lesbonicus, and informs him that he is to be married to the daughter of Callicles.

THE ACROSTIC ARGUMENT. [1]
CHARMIDES, going abroad, entrusts a treasure (Thesaurum) secretly hidden, and all his property (Rem), to his friend Callicles. He (Istoc) being absent, his son wantonly squanders his estate. For (Nam) he sells even the house: and Callicles makes purchase of it. His sister, a maiden (Virgo) without a dowry, is asked in marriage. That in a less degree (Minus), with censure, Callicles may bestow on her a dowry, he commissions one (Mandat) to say that he has brought the gold from her father. When (Ut) the Counterfeit has reached the house, the old man (Senex), Charmides, as he has just returned, disappoints him; his children then are married.

((Enter LUXURY and POVERTY. [2])

LUXURY.
Follow me this way, daughter, that you may perform your office.

POVERTY.
I am following, but I know not what to say will be the end of our journey.

LUXURY.
’Tis here. See, this is the house. Now go you in.(((Exit POVERTY, who enters the house of CHARMIDES.))) ((to the AUDIENCE.)) Now, that no one of you may be mistaken, in a few words
I will conduct you into the right path, if, indeed, you promise to listen to me. First, then, I will now tell you who I am, and who she is who has gone in here ((pointing to the house)) , if you give your attention. In the first place, Plautus has given me the name of Luxury, and then he has willed that this Poverty should be my daughter.
But why, at my suggestion, she has just entered here, listen and give attentive ear while I inform you. There is a certain young man who is living in this house; by my assistance he has squandered away his paternal estate. Since I see that there is nothing left for him to support me,
I have given him my daughter, together with whom to pass his life. But expect nothing about the plot of this play: the old men who will come hither will disclose the matter to you. The name of this play in the Greek is The Treasure [Thesaurus]; Philemon wrote it [3] : Plautus translated it into Latin [4] ,
and gave it the name of The Three Pieces of Money [Trinummus]. Now, he begs this of you, that it may be allowed the play to keep that name. Thus much have I to say. Farewell. Attend in silence. ((Exit.))

((Enter MEGARONIDES.))

MEGARONIDES
To reprove one’s friend for a fault that deserves it, is a thankless task; but sometimes ’tis useful
and ’tis profitable. Therefore, this day will I soundly reprove my friend for a fault that much deserves it. Unwilling am I, did not my friendship bid me do it. For this faultiness has encroached too much upon good morals, so drooping now are nearly all of them.
But while they are in this distempered state, bad morals, in the mean time, have sprung up most plenteously, like well-watered plants; nor is there now anything abundant here but these same bad morals. Of them you may now reap a most plenteous harvest:
and here a set of men are making the favour of a few of much more value than that in which they may benefit the many. Thus private interests outdo that which is to the public advantage—interests which in many points are a hindrance, and a nuisance, and cause an obstruction both to private and to public welfare.

((Enter CALLICLES.))

CALLICLES
((as he enters.))
I wish our household God [5] to be graced with a chaplet.
Wife [6] ((addressing her within)) , pay him due respect, that this dwelling may turn out for us prosperous, lucky, happy, and fortunate; and ((in a lower voice)) that, as soon as I possibly may, I may see you dead and gone.

MEGARONIDES
This is he who in his old age has become a child [7] —who has been guilty of a fault that deserves correction.
I will accost the man.

CALLICLES
((looking around.))
Whose voice is it that sounds near me?

MEGARONIDES
Of one who wishes you well, if you are as I desire you to be; but, if you are otherwise, of one who is your enemy, and is angry with you.

CALLICLES
Health to you, O my friend and years'-mate! How are you, Megaronides?

MEGARONIDES
And, i' faith [8] health to you, Callicles!
Are you well? Have you been well?

CALLICLES
I am well, and I have been still better.

MEGARONIDES
And how does your wife do? How is she?

CALLICLES
Better than I wish.

MEGARONIDES
'Tis well, i' faith, for you, that she is alive and well

CALLICLES
Troth, I believe that you are glad if I have any misfortune.

MEGARONIDES
That which I have, I wish for all my friends as well.

CALLICLES
Harkye, how does your wife do?

MEGARONIDES
She is immortal; she lives, and is likely to live.

CALLICLES
I’ faith, you tell me good news; and I pray the Gods that, surviving you, she may last out your life.

MEGARONIDES
By my troth! if indeed she were only married to yourself, I could wish it sincerely.

CALLICLES
Do you wish that we should exchange?—that I should take yours, and you mine?
I’d be making you not to get a bit the better of the bargain of me.

MEGARONIDES
Indeed, I fancy [9] you would not be surprising me unawares.

CALLICLES
Aye, faith, I should cause you not to be knowing [10] the thing you were about.

MEGARONIDES
Keep what you’ve got; the evil that we know is the best. But if I were now to take one that I know not, I should not know what to do.

CALLICLES
In good sooth, just as one lives [11] a long life, one lives a happy life.

MEGARONIDES
But give your attention to this, and have done with your joking, for I am come hither to you for a given purpose.

CALLICLES
Why have you come?

MEGARONIDES
That I may rebuke you soundly with many harsh words.

CALLICLES
Me, do you say?

MEGARONIDES
Is there any one else here besides you and me?

CALLICLES
((looking about.))
There is no one.

MEGARONIDES
Why, then, do you ask if ’tis you I mean to rebuke? Unless, indeed, you think that I am about to reprove my own self. For if your former principles now flag in you, or if the manners of the age are working a change in your disposition, and if you preserve not those of the olden time, but are catching up these new ones,
you will strike all your friends with a malady so direful, that they will turn sick at seeing and hearing you.

CALLICLES
How comes it into your mind to utter these expressions?

MEGARONIDES
Because it becomes all good men and all good women to have a care to keep suspicion and guilt away from themselves.

CALLICLES
Both cannot be done.

MEGARONIDES
Why so?

CALLICLES
Do you ask? I am the keeper of my own heart so as not to admit guilt there; suspicion is centred in the heart of another. For if now I should suspect that you had stolen the crown from the head of Jupiter in the Capitol [12] , the statue which stands on the highest summit of the temple; if you had not done so, and still it should please me to suspect you, how could you prevent me from suspecting you? But I am anxious to know what this matter is.

MEGARONIDES
Have you any friend or intimate acquaintance
whose judgment is correct?

CALLICLES
Troth, I'll tell you without reserve. There are some whom I know to be friends; there are some whom I suspect to be so, but whose dispositions and feelings I am unable to discover, whether they incline to the side of a friend or an enemy; but of my assured friends, you are the most assured.
If you know that I have done anything unwittingly or wrongfully, and if you do not accuse me of it, then you yourself will be to blame.

MEGARONIDES
I know it; and if I had come hither to you for any other purpose, you request what is right.

CALLICLES
If you have anything to say, I am waiting for it.

MEGARONIDES
Then, first of all, you are badly spoken of in general conversation by the public.
Your fellow-citizens are calling you greedy of grovelling gain [13] ; and then, again, there are others who nickname you a vulture [14] , and say that you care but little whether you devour enemies or fellow-citizens. Since I have heard these things said against you, I have, to my misery, been sadly agitated.

CALLICLES
It is, and it is not, in my power, Megaronides:
as to their saying this, that is not in my power; as to their saying this deservedly, that is in my power.

MEGARONIDES

Was this Charmides a friend of yours? ((He points to the house of CHARMIDES.))

CALLICLES
He both is and he was. That you may believe it to be so, I will tell you a circumstance as a proof. For after this son of his had squandered away his fortune, and he saw himself being reduced to poverty,
and that his daughter was grown up a young woman, and that she who was both her mother and his own wife was dead; as he himself was about to go hence to Seleueia [15] he committed to my charge the maiden his daughter, and all his property, and that profligate son.
These, I think, he would not have entrusted to me if he had been unfriendly to me.

MEGARONIDES
What say you as to the young man, who you see to be thus profligate, and who has been entrusted to your care and confidence? Why do you not reform him? Why do you not train him to frugal habits? It would have been somewhat more just for you to give attention to that matter,
if you could have somehow made him a better man, and not for you yourself to be a party to the same disreputable conduct, and share your dishonour with his disgrace?

CALLICLES
What have I done?

MEGARONIDES
That which a bad man would do.

CALLICLES
That is no name of mine.

MEGARONIDES
Have you not bought this house from that young man? ((A pause.)) Why are you silent?
This, where you yourself are now living. ((He points to the house of CHARMIDES.))

CALLICLES
I did buy it, and I gave the money for it,—forty minae [16] , to the young man himself, into his own hand.

MEGARONIDES
You gave the money, do you say?

CALLICLES
’Twas done; and I am not sorry ’twas done.

MEGARONIDES
I’ faith—a young man committed to untrusty keeping. Have you not by these means given him a sword with which to slay himself?
For, prithee, what else is it, your giving ready money to a young man who loves women, and weak in intellect, with which to complete his edifice of folly which he had already commenced?

CALLICLES
Ought I not to have paid him the money?

MEGARONIDES
You ought not to have paid him; nor ought you either to have bought anything of or sold anything to him; nor should you have provided him with the means of becoming worse. Have you not taken in the person who was entrusted to you? Have you not driven out of his house the man who entrusted him to you? By my faith, a pretty trust, and a faithful guardianship! Leave him to take care of himself; he would manage his own affairs much better.

CALLICLES
You overpower me, Megaronides, with your accusations, in a manner so strange, that what was privately entrusted to my secrecy, fidelity, and constancy, for me to tell it to no one, nor make it public, the same I am now compelled to entrust to you.

MEGARONIDES
Whatever you shall entrust to me, you shall take up the same where you have laid it down.

CALLICLES
Look round you, then, that no overlooker may be near us ((MEGARONIDES looks on every side)) ; and look around every now and then, I beg of you.

MEGARONIDES
I am listening if you have aught to say.

CALLICLES
If you will be silent, I will speak. At the time when Charmides set out hence for foreign parts, he showed me a treasure in this house, here in a certain closet— ((He starts as if he hears a noise.)) But do look around.

MEGARONIDES
There is no one.

CALLICLES
Of Philippean pieces [17] to the number of three thousand. Alone with myself, in tears, he entreated me, by our friendship and by my honour, not to entrust this to his son, nor yet to any one, from whom that might come to his knowledge.
Now, if he comes back hither safe, I will restore to him his own. But if anything should happen to him, at all events I have a stock from which to give a marriage-portion to his daughter, who has been entrusted to me, that I may settle her in a condition of life that befits her.

MEGARONIDES
O ye immortal gods! how soon, in a few words, you have made another man of me; I came to you quite a different person. But, as you have begun, proceed further to inform me.

CALLICLES
What shall I tell you? How that this worthless fellow had almost utterly ruined his caution and my own trustiness and all the secret.

MEGARONIDES
How so?

CALLICLES
Because, while I was in the country for only six days, in my absence and without my knowledge, without consulting me, he advertised with bills [18] this house for sale.

MEGARONIDES
The wolf hungered the more, and opened his mouth the wider;
he watched till [19] the dog went to sleep; and intended to carry off the whole entire flock.

CALLICLES
I' faith, he would have done it, if the dogs had not perceived this in time. But now, in my turn, I wish to ask you this: let me know what it was my duty for me to do.
Whether was it right for me to discover the treasure to him, against which very thing his father had cautioned me, or should I have permitted another person to become the owner of this house? Ought that money to have belonged to him who bought the house? In preference, I myself bought the house; I gave the money
for the sake of the treasure, that I might deliver it safe to my friend. I have not, then, bought this house either for myself or for my own use; for Charmides have I bought it back again; from my own store have I paid the money.
This, whether it has been done rightfully or wrongfully, I own, Megaronides, that I have done.
Here, then, are my misdeeds; here, then, is my avarice. Is it for these things that they spread false reports against me?

MEGARONIDES
Stay—you have overcome your corrector. You have tied my tongue; there is nothing for me to say in answer.

CALLICLES
Now I entreat you to aid me with your assistance and counsel,
and to share this duty of mine in common with me.

MEGARONIDES
I promise you my assistance.

CALLICLES
Where, then, will you be a short time hence?

MEGARONIDES
At home.

CALLICLES
Do you wish anything else?

MEGARONIDES
Attend to the trust reposed in you.

CALLICLES
That is being carefully done.

MEGARONIDES
But how say you—?

CALLICLES
What do you want?

MEGARONIDES
Where is the young man living now?

CALLICLES
This back part [20] of the building he retained when he sold the house.

MEGARONIDES
That I wanted to know. Now, then, go at once. But what say you, where is the damsel now? She is at your house, I suppose?

CALLICLES
She is so; I take care of her almost as much as of my own daughter.

MEGARONIDES
You act properly.

CALLICLES
Before I go away, are you going to ask me anything else?

MEGARONIDES
Farewell. ((Exit CALLICLES.)) Really, there is nothing more foolish or more stupid,
nothing more lying or indeed more tattling, more self-conceited or more forsworn, than those men of this city everlastingly gossiping about, whom they call Busybodies [21] . And thus have I enlisted myself in their ranks together with them; who have been the swallower of the false tales
of those who pretend that they know everything, and yet know nothing. They know, forsooth, what each person either has in his mind, or is likely to have; they know what the king whispered in the ear of the queen; they know what Juno talked about in conversation with Jupiter; that which neither is nor is likely to be, do these fellows know.
Whether they praise or dispraise any one they please, falsely or truly, they care not a straw, so they know that which they choose to know. All people were in the habit of saying that this Callicles was unworthy of this state, and, himself, to exist, who had despoiled this young man of his property.
From the reports of these tale-bearers, in my ignorance I rushed forward to rebuke my guiltless friend. But if the authority was always required from the foundation, upon which they speak of anything they have heard, unless that clearly appeared, the matter ought to be to the peril and loss of the tale-bearer.
If this were so, it would be for the public benefit. I would cause those to be but few, who now that which they do not know [22] , and I would make them have their silly chattering more restricted. ((Exit.))

((Enter LYSITELES.))

LYSITELES
I am revolving many things in my mind at once, and much uneasiness do I find in thinking upon them.
I tease, and fret, and wear myself out; a mind that enjoins a hard task [23] is now my master. But this thing is not clear to me, nor has it been enough studied by me, which pursuit of these two I should rather follow for myself; which of the two I should think of the greater stability for passing my life therein:
whether it were preferable for me to devote myself to love or to aggrandisement; in which alternative there is more

enjoyment of life in passing one’s days. On this point I am not fully satisfied. But this I think I’ll do, that I may weigh both the points together, I must be both judge and culprit in this trial:
I’ll do so—I like it much. First of all, I will enlarge upon the pursuits of love, how they conduce to one’s welfare. Love never expects any but the willing man to throw himself in his toils; these he seeks for, these he follows up, and craftily counsels against their interests. He is a fawning flatterer, a rapacious grappler [24] , a deceiver, a sweet-tooth, a spoiler, a corrupter of men who court retirement, a pryer into secrets. For he that is in love, soon as ever he has been smitten with the kisses of the object that he loves, forthwith his substance vanishes out of doors and melts away. Give me this thing [25] , my honey, if you love me, if you possibly can.
And then this gudgeon says: O apple of my eye, be it so: both that shall be given you, and still more, if you wish it to be given. Then does she strike while he is wavering [26] ; and now she begs for more. Not enough is this evil, unless there is still something more—what to eat, what to drink. A thing that creates [27] a further expense, the favour of a night is granted; a whole family is then introduced for her—a wardrobe-woman [28] a perfume-keeper [29] , a cofferer, fan-bearers [30] , sandal-bearers [31] , singing-girls, casket-keepers [32] , messengers, news-carriers, so many wasters of his bread and substance. The lover himself, while to them he is complaisant, becomes a beggar.
When I revolve these things in my mind, and when I reflect how little one is valued when he is in need; away with you, Love—I like you not—no converse do I hold with you. Although ’tis sweet to feast and to carouse, Love still gives bitters enough to be distasteful.
He avoids the Courts [33] of justice, he drives away your relations, and drives yourself away from your own contemplation. Nor do men wish that he should be called their friend. In a thousand ways is Love to be held a stranger, to be kept at a distance, and to be wholly abstained from.
For he who plunges into love, perishes more dreadfully than if he leapt from a rock. Away with you, Love, if you please; keep your owns [34] property to yourself. Love, never be you a friend of mine; some there are, however, whom, in their misery, you may keep miserable and wretched—
those whom you have easily rendered submissive to yourself. My fixed determination is to apply my mind to my advancement in life, although, in that, great labour is undergone by the mind. Good men wish these things for themselves, gain, credit, and honour, glory, and esteem; these are the rewards of the upright.
It delights me, then, the more, to live together with the upright rather than with the deceitful promulgators of lies.

((Enter PHILTO.))

PHILTO
((looking about.))
Where has this man betaken himself out of doors from the house?

LYSITELES
((coming up to him.))
I am here, father; command me what you will, and I shall cause no delay to you, nor will I hide myself in any skulking-place out of your sight.

PHILTO
You will be doing what is consonant to the rest of your conduct if you reverence your father. By your duty to me, my son, I wish you, for my sake, not to hold any converse with profligate men, either in the street or in the Forum. I know this age—what its manners are.
The bad man wishes the good man to be bad, that he may be like himself. The wicked, the rapacious, the covetous, and the envious, disorder and confound the morals of the age: a crew gaping for gain, they hold the sacred thing as profane—the public advantage as the private emolument. At these things do I grieve, these are the matters that torment me. These things am I constantly repeating both day and night, that you may use due precaution against

them.
They only deem it right to keep their hands off that which they cannot touch with their hands; as to the rest, seize it, carry it off, keep it, be off and go hide, that is the word with them. These things, when I behold them, draw tears from me, because I have survived to see such a race of men. Why have I not rather descended to the dead [35] ere this?
For these men praise the manners of our ancestors, and defile those same persons whom they commend. With regard, then, to these pursuits, I enjoin you not to taint your disposition with them. Live after my fashion, and according to the ancient manners; what I am prescribing to you, the same do you remember and practise. I have no patience with these fashionable manners, upsetting preconceived notions, with which good men are now disgracing themselves.
If you follow these my injunctions to you, many a good maxim will take root in your breast.

LYSITELES
From my earliest youth, even up to this present age, I have always, father, paid all submission to the injunctions you have given. So far as my nature was concerned, I considered that I was free; so far as your injunctions were concerned, I deemed it proper that my mind should pay all submission to you.

PHILTO
The man who is struggling with his inclination from his earliest age, whether he ought to prefer to be so, as his inclination thinks it proper that he should be, or whether, rather so as his parents and his relations wish him to be—if his inclination conquers that man, it is all over with him; he is the slave of his inclination and not of himself. But if he conquers his inclination, he truly lives and shall be famed as a conqueror of conquerors.
If you have conquered your inclination rather than your inclination you, you have reason to rejoice. 'Tis better by far that you should be such as you ought to be, than such as pleases your inclination. Those who conquer the inclination will ever be esteemed better men than those whom the inclination subdues.

LYSITELES
I have ever esteemed these maxims as the shield of my youthful age; never to betake myself to any place where vice was the order of the day [36] ,
never to go to stroll about at night, nor to take from another that which is his. I have taken all precautions, my father, that I might not cause you uneasiness; I have ever kept your precepts in due preservation [37] by my own rule of conduct.

PHILTO
And do you reproach me, because you have acted aright? For yourself have you done so, not for me: my life, indeed, is nearly past [38] ; this matter principally concerns your own.
Keep on overlaying [39] good deeds with other good deeds, that the rain may not come through. He is the upright man who is not content with it, however upright and however honest he may chance to be. He who readily gives satisfaction to himself, is not the upright man, nor is he really honest: he who thinks but meanly of himself, in him is there a tendency to well-doing.

LYSITELES
For this reason, father, I have thought that since there is a certain thing that I wish for,
I would request it of you.

PHILTO
What is it? I am already longing to give assent.

LYSITELES
A young man here, of noble family, my friend and years' mate, who has managed his own affairs but heedlessly and unthinkingly—I wish, father, to do him a service, if you are not unwilling.

PHILTO
From your own means, I suppose?

LYSITELES
From my own means—for what is yours is mine, and all mine is yours.

PHILTO
What is he doing? Is he in want?

LYSITELES
He is in want.

PHILTO
Had he property?

LYSITELES
He had.

PHILTO
How did he lose it? Was he connected with public business [40] , or with commercial matters? Had he merchandise or wares to sell, when he lost his property?

LYSITELES
None of these.

PHILTO
What then?

LYSITELES
I' faith, my father, by his good-nature. Besides, to indulge his tastes, he wasted some part of it in luxury.

PHILTO
By my troth now! a fellow spoken of boldly, and as on familiar terms;—one, indeed, who has never dissipated his fortune by any good means, and is now in want. I cannot brook that, with qualities of that description, he should be your friend.

LYSITELES
'Tis because he is without any bad disposition that I wish to relieve his wants.

PHILTO
He deserves ill of a beggar who gives him what to eat or to drink;
for he both loses that which he gives and prolongs for the other a life of misery. I do not say this because I am unwilling and would not readily do what you desire; but when I apply these expressions to that same person, I am warning you beforehand, so to have compassion on others, that others may not have to pity you.

LYSITELES
I am ashamed to desert him, and to deny him aid in his adversity.

PHILTO
I' troth, shame is preferable to repentance by just as many letters [41] as it consists of.

LYSITELES
In good sooth, father, by the care of the Gods, and of my forefathers, and your own, I may say that we possess much property, honestly obtained. If you do a service to a friend, it ought not to make you repent that you have done so; it ought rather to cause you shame if you do not do it.

PHILTO
If from great wealth you subtract something, does it become more or less?

LYSITELES
Less, father. But do you know what is wont to be repeated to the niggardly citizen [42] ? That which thou hast mayst thou not have, and mayst thou have that misfortune which thou hast not; since thou canst neither endure it to be enjoyed by thyself nor by another.

PHILTO
I know, indeed, that so it usually is: but, my son, he is the truly niggardly man [43] that has nought with which to pay his dues.

LYSITELES
By the care of the Gods, we have, father, both enough for us to enjoy ourselves, and with which to do kind offices to kind-hearted men.

PHILTO
Troth, I am not able to refuse you anything that you; ask of me. Whose poverty do you wish to relieve? Speak out boldly to your father.

LYSITELES
That of this young man Lesbonicus, the son of Charmides, who lives there. ((He points to the house of CHARMIDES.))

PHILTO
Why, hasn't he devoured both what he had, and what he had not [44] ?

LYSITELES
Censure him not, my father: many things happen to a man which he likes, many, too, which he does not like.

PHILTO
Troth, you say falsely, son; and you are doing so now not according to your usual wont. For the prudent man, i' faith, really frames his own fortunes for himself: many things, therefore, do not happen which he does not like, unless he is a bungling workman.

LYSITELES

Much labour is requisite for this workmanship in him who seeks to be a clever workman in fashioning his life—but he is still very young.

PHILTO
Not by years but by disposition is wisdom acquired. Age is the relish of wisdom—wisdom is the nutriment of old age. However, come, say what you wish now to give him.

LYSITELES
Nothing at all, father.
Do you only not hinder me from accepting it if he should give anything to me.

PHILTO
And will you be relieving his poverty by that, if you shall accept anything of him?

LYSITELES
By that very means, my father.

PHILTO
Faith, I wish that you would instruct me in that method.

LYSITELES
Certainly. Do you know of what family he is born?

PHILTO
I know—of an extremely honourable one.

LYSITELES
He has a sister—a fine young woman now grown up: I wish, father,
to take her without a portion for my wife.

PHILTO
A wife without a portion?

LYSITELES
Just so—your riches saved as well. By these means you will be conferring an extreme favour on him, and in no way could you help him to greater advantage.

PHILTO
Am I to suffer you to take a wife without a portion?

LYSITELES
You must suffer it, father; and by these means you will be giving an estimable character to our family.

PHILTO
I could give utterance to many a learned saying, and very fluently too: this old age of mine retains stories of old and ancient times. But, since I see that you are courting friendship and esteem for our family, although I have been opposed to you, I thus give my decision—I will permit you; ask for the girl, and marry her.

LYSITELES
May the Gods preserve you to me.
But, to this favour add one thing.

PHILTO
But what is this one thing?

LYSITELES
I will tell you. Do you go to him, do you solicit him, and do you ask for her yourself.

PHILTO
Think of that now.

LYSITELES
You will transact it much more speedily: all will be made sure of that you do. One word of yours in this matter will be of more consequence than a hundred of mine.

PHILTO
See, now, how, in my kindness, I have undertaken this matter.
My assistance shall be given.

LYSITELES
You really are a kind father. This is the house here he dwells. ((He points to the house of CHARMIDES.)) Lesbonicus is his name. Mind and attend to the business; I will await you at home. ((Exit.))

((PHILTO, alone.))

PHILTO
These things are not for the best, nor as I think they ought to be; but still, they are better than that which is downright bad. But this one circumstance consoles myself and my thoughts-namely,
that he who counsels in respect to a son nothing else but that which pleases himself alone, only plays the fool; he becomes wretched in mind, and yet he is no nearer bringing it about. He is preparing a very inclement winter for his own old age when he arouses that unseasonable storm.
((The door of the house of CHARMIDES opens.)) But the house is opened to which I was going; most conveniently, Lesbonicus himself is coming out of doors with his servant. ((PHILTO retires to a distance.))

((Enter LESBONICUS and STASIMUS.))

LESBONICUS
’Tis less than fifteen days since you received from Callicles forty minae for this house; is it not as I say, Stasimus?

STASIMUS
When I consider,
I think I remember that it was so.

LESBONICUS
What has been done with it?

STASIMUS
It has been eaten and drunk up—spent away in unguents, washed away in baths [45] . The fishmonger and the baker have carried it off: butchers, too, and cooks, green-grocers, perfumers, and poulterers; ’twas quickly consumed. I’ faith! that money was made away with not less speedily
than if you were to throw a poppy among the ants.

LESBONICUS
By my troth, less has been spent on those items than six minae?

STASIMUS
Besides, what have you given to your mistresses?

LESBONICUS
That I am including as well in it.

STASIMUS
Besides, what have I pilfered of it?

LESBONICUS
Aye, that item is a very heavy one.

STASIMUS
That cannot so appear to you, if you make all due deductions [46] ,
unless you think that your money is everlasting.
((Aside.)) Too late and unwisely,—a caution that should have been used before,—after he has devoured his substance, he reckons up the account too late.

LESBONICUS
The account, however, of this money is by no means clear.

STASIMUS
I’ faith, the account is very clear: the money’s gone [47] .
Did you not receive forty minae from Callicles, and did he not receive from you the house in possession?

LESBONICUS
Very good.

PHILTO
((aside.))
Troth, I think our neighbour has sold his house [48] . When his father shall come from abroad, his place is in the beggar’s gate [49] , unless, perchance, he should creep into his son’s stomach [50] .

STASIMUS
There were a thousand Olympic drachmae [51] paid to the banker [52] , which you were owing upon account.

LESBONICUS
Those, I suppose, that I was security for [53] ?

STASIMUS
Say, rather [54] , Those that I paid down—for that young man whom you used to say [55] was so rich.

LESBONICUS
It was so done.

STASIMUS
Yes, just to be squandered away.

LESBONICUS
That was done as well.
But I saw him in a pitiable state, and I did have pity on him.

STASIMUS
You have pity on others, and you have neither pity nor shame for yourself.

PHILTO
((aside.))
’Tis time to accost him.

LESBONICUS
Is this Philto that is coming here? Troth, ’tis he himself.

STASIMUS
I’ faith, I could wish he was my slave, together with his savings [56] .

PHILTO
Philto right heartily wishes health to both master and servant, Lesbonicus and Stasimus.

LESBONICUS
May the Gods give you, Philto, whatever you may wish for. How is your son?

PHILTO
He wishes well to you.

LESBONICUS
In good sooth, he does for me what I do for him in return!

STASIMUS
((aside.))
That phrase, He wishes well, is worthless, unless a person does well too.
I, too, wish to be a free man; I wish in vain. He, perhaps, might wish to become frugal; he would wish to no purpose.

PHILTO
My son has sent me to you to propose an alliance and bond of friendship between himself and your family. He wishes to take your sister for his wife; and I
have the same feelings, and I desire it.

LESBONICUS
I really don’t understand your ways; amid your prosperity you are laughing at my adversity.

PHILTO
I am a man [57] : you are a man. So may Jupiter love me, I have neither come to laugh at you, nor do I think you deserving of it! But as to what I said, my son begged me
to ask for your sister as his wife.

LESBONICUS
It is right that I should know the state of my own circumstances. My position is not on an equal footing with yours; seek some other alliance for yourselves.

STASIMUS
((to LESBONICUS.))
Are you really sound in mind or intellect
to refuse this proposal? For I perceive that he has been found for you a very friend in need [58] .

LESBONICUS
Get away hence, and go hang yourself [59] .

STASIMUS
Faith, if I should commence to go, you would be forbidding me [60] .

LESBONICUS
Unless you want me, Philto, for anything else, I have given you my answer.

PHILTO
I trust, Lesbonicus, that you
will one day be more obliging to me than I now find you to be. For both to act [61] unwisely and to talk unwisely, Lesbonicus, are sometimes neither of them profitable.

STASIMUS
Troth, he says what’s true.

LESBONICUS
I will tear out your eye if you add one word.

STASIMUS
Troth, but I will talk;
for if I may not be allowed to do so as I am, then I will submit to be called the one-eyed man [62] .

PHILTO
Do you now say this, that your position and means are not on an equal footing with ours?

LESBONICUS
I do say so.

PHILTO
Well, suppose, now, you were to come to a building to a public banquet, and a wealthy man by chance were to come there as your neighbour [63] .
The banquet is set on table, one that they style a public one [64] . Suppose that dainties were heaped up before him by his dependents, and suppose any-thing pleased you that was so heaped up before him, would you eat, or would you keep your place next to this wealthy man, going without your dinner?

LESBONICUS
I should eat, unless he were to forbid me doing so.

STASIMUS
But I, by my faith, even if he were to forbid me,
would eat and cram with both cheeks stuffed out; and what pleased him, that, in especial, would I lay hold of beforehand; nor would I yield to him one jot of my very existence. At table it befits no one to be bashful; for there the decision [65] is about things both divine and human.

PHILTO
You say what is the fact.

STASIMUS
I will tell you without any subterfuge: I would make place for him on the highway, on the footpath, in the canvass for public honors; but as to what concerns the stomach—by my troth, not this much ((shows the breadth of his finger-nail)) , unless he should first have thrashed me with his fists. With provisions at the present prices, a feast is a fortune without incumbrances [66] .

PHILTO
Always, Lesbonicus, do you take care and think this, that that is the best, according as you yourself are the most deserving: if that you cannot attain to, at least be as near as possible to the most deserving. And now, Lesbonicus, I wish you to grant and accept these terms which I propose, and which I ask of you.
The Gods are rich; wealth and station befit the Gods: but we poor mortal beings are, as it were, the salt-cellar [67] for the salt of life. The moment that we have breathed forth this, the beggar is held of equal value at Acheron [68] with the most wealthy man when dead.

STASIMUS
((aside.))
It will be a wonder if you don’t carry your riches there with you. When you are dead, you may, perhaps, be as good as your name imports [69] .

PHILTO
Now, that you may understand that position and means have no place here, and that we do not undervalue your alliance; I ask for your sister without a marriage-portion.
May the matter turn out happily. Do I understand her to be promised? Why are you silent?

STASIMUS
O immortal Gods, what a proposal!

PHILTO
Why don’t you say, May the Gods prosper it, I agree [70] ?

STASIMUS
((aside.))
Alas! when there was no advantage in the expression, he used to say, I agree; now, when there is advantage in it, he is not able to say so.

LESBONICUS
Since you think me, Philto, worthy of an alliance with you, I return you many thanks. But though this fortune of mine has sadly diminished through my folly, I have, Philto, a piece of land near the city here; that I will give as a portion to my sister: for, after all my follies,
that alone, besides my existence, is left me.

PHILTO
Really I care nothing at all about a portion.

LESBONICUS
I am determined to give her one.

STASIMUS
((whispers to LESBONICUS.))
And are you ready, master, to sever that nurse from us which is supporting us? Take care how you do it. What are we ourselves to eat in future?

LESBONICUS
((to STASIMUS.))
Once more, will you hold your tongue?
Am I to be rendered accountable to you?

STASIMUS
((aside.))
We are evidently done for, unless I devise something or other. Philto, I want you. ((He remeoves to a distance, and beckons to PHILTO.))

PHILTO
If you wish aught, Stasimus.

STASIMUS
Step a little this way.

PHILTO
By all means.

STASIMUS
I tell you this in secrecy, that neither he nor any one else may learn it of you.

PHILTO
Trust me boldly with anything you please.

STASIMUS
By Gods and men I warn you, not to allow that piece of land ever to become yours or your son’s. I’ll tell you my reasons for this matter.

PHILTO
Troth, I should like to hear them.

STASIMUS
First of all then, when at any time the ground is being ploughed, in every fifth furrow the oxen die.

PHILTO
Preserve me from it. [71]

STASIMUS
The gate of Acheron is in that land of ours.
Then the grapes, before they are ripe, hang in a putrid state.

LESBONICUS
((in a low voice.))
He is persuading the man to something, I think. Although he is a rogue, still he is not unfaithful to me.

STASIMUS
Hear the rest. Besides that, when elsewhere the harvest of wheat is most abundant,
there it comes up less by one-fourth than what you have sowed.

PHILTO
Ah! bad habits ought to be sown on that spot, if in the sowing they can be killed.

STASIMUS
And never is there any person to whom that piece of land belongs, but that his affairs turn out most unfortunate. Of those to whom it has belonged,
some have gone away in banishment; some are dead outright; some, again, have hanged themselves. See this man, now, to whom it belongs, how he has been brought to a regular backgammoned state [72] .

PHILTO
Preserve me from this piece of land.

STASIMUS
Preserve me from it, you would say still more, if you were to hear everything from me. For there every other tree has been blasted with lightning;
the hogs die [73] there most shockingly of inflammation in the throat; the sheep are scabby, as bare of all wool, see, as is this hand of mine. And then, besides, there is not one of the Syrian natives [74] , a race which is the most hardy of men, who could exist there for six months; so surely do all die there of the solstitial fever [75] .

PHILTO
I believe, Stasimus [76] , that it is so; but the Campanian [77] race much outdoes that of the Syrians in hardiness. But, really, that piece of land, as I have heard you describe it, is one to which it were proper for all wicked men to be sent for the public good. Just as they tell of the Islands of the Blest,

where all meet together who have passed their lives uprightly: on the other hand, it seems proper that all evildoers should be packed off there, since it is a place of such a character.

STASIMUS
’Tis a very receptacle of calamity. What need is there of many words? Look for any bad thing whatsoever, there you may find it.

PHILTO
But, i’ faith, you may find it there and elsewhere too.

STASIMUS
Please, take care not to say that I told you of this.

PHILTO
You have told it me in perfect secrecy.

STASIMUS
For he, indeed ((pointing at LESBONICUS)) , wishes it to be got rid of from himself, if he can find any one to impose upon [78] about it.

PHILTO
I’ faith, this land shall never become my property.

STASIMUS
Aye, if you keep in your senses.
((Aside.)) I’ faith, I have cleverly frightened [79] the old fellow away from this land; for, if my master had parted with it, there is nothing for us to live upon.

PHILTO
Lesbonicus, I now return to you.

LESBONICUS
Tell me, if you please, what has he been saying to you?

PHILTO
What do you suppose? He is a man [80] ; he wishes to become a free man, but he has not the money to give.

LESBONICUS
And I wish to be rich, but all in vain.

STASIMUS
((aside.))
You might have been, if you had chosen; now, since you have nothing, you cannot be.

LESBONICUS
What are you talking about to yourself, Stasimus?

STASIMUS

About that which you were saying just now: if you had chosen formerly, you might have been rich; now you are wishing too late.

PHILTO
No terms can be come to with me about the marriage-portion;
whatever pleases you, do you transact it yourself with my son. Now, I ask for your sister for my son; and may the matter turn out well. What now? are you still considering?

LESBONICUS
What—about that matter? Since you will have it so—may the Gods prosper it—I promise her.

PHILTO
Never, by my troth, was a son
born so ardently longed for by any one, as was that expression I promise her, when born for me.

STASIMUS
The Gods will prosper all your plans.

PHILTO
So I wish.
Come this way with me, Lesbonicus, that a day may be agreed on for the nuptials, in the presence of Lysiteles: this agreement we will ratify on that same day. ((Exit PHILTO.))

LESBONICUS
Now, Stasimus, go you there ((points to the house which he has sold to CALLICLES)) to the house of Callicles, to my sister; tell her how this matter has been arranged.

STASIMUS
I will go.

LESBONICUS
And congratulate my sister.

STASIMUS
Very well.

LESBONICUS
Tell Callicles to meet me—

STASIMUS
But rather do you go now—

LESBONICUS
That he may see what is necessary to be done about the portion.

STASIMUS
Do go now.

LESBONICUS
For I have determined not to give her without a portion.

STASIMUS
But rather do you go now.

LESBONICUS
And I will never allow it to be a detriment to her by reason of—

STASIMUS
Do be off now.

LESBONICUS
My recklessness—

STASIMUS
Do go now [81] .

LESBONICUS
It seems by no means just, but that, since I have done wrong—

STASIMUS
Do go now.

LESBONICUS
It should be chiefly a detriment to myself.

STASIMUS
Do go now.

LESBONICUS
O my father!
and shall I ever see you again?

STASIMUS
Do go now. Go—go now.

LESBONICUS
I am going.
Do you take care of that which I have asked you. I shall be here directly. ((Exit LESBONICUS.))

STASIMUS
At length I have prevailed on him to go. In the name of the immortal Gods, i' faith, 'tis a matter well managed by wrongful means of performance, inasmuch as our piece of land is safe; although even now 'tis still a very doubtful matter what may be the result of this affair.
But, if the land is parted with, 'tis all over [82] with my neck; I must carry a buckler in foreign lands, a helmet too, and my baggage. He will be running away from the city when the nuptials have been celebrated; he will be going hence to extreme and utter ruin, somewhere or other, to serve as a soldier, either to Asia or to Cilicia [83] .

I will go there ((looking at the door of the house bought by CALLICLES)) , where he has ordered me to go, although I detest this house ever since he has driven us out of our abode. ((Exit into the house of CHARMIDES.))

((Enter CALLICLES and STASIMUS.))

CALLICLES
To what effect were you speaking about this, Stasimus?

STASIMUS
That Lesbonicus, the son of my master, has betrothed his sister; in those terms.

CALLICLES
To what person has he betrothed her?

STASIMUS
To Lysiteles, the son of Philto; without a portion, too.

CALLICLES
Without a portion, will he marry her into a family so rich [84] ? You are telling me a thing not to be credited.

STASIMUS
Why, faith, you would be for never believing. If you don’t believe this, at all events I shall be believing—

CALLICLES
What?

STASIMUS
That I don’t care a fig for your belief.

CALLICLES
How long since, or where, was this matter agreed to?

STASIMUS
On this very spot—here, before his door ((pointing to PHILTO’S house)) . This moment-like [85] , as the man of Praeneste says.

CALLICLES
And has Lesbonicus, amid his ruined fortunes, become so much more frugal than in his prosperous circumstances?

STASIMUS
Why, in fact, Philto himself came of his own accord to make the offer for his son.

CALLICLES
((aside.))
By my troth, it really will be a disgrace, if a portion is not given to the maiden. In fine, I think, i’ faith, that that matter concerns myself. I will go to my corrector, and will ask advice of him. ((Exit.))

STASIMUS

I pretty nearly guess, and I have a strong suspicion, why he makes such speed on this: namely, that he may turn Lesbonicus out of his bit of land, after he has turned him out of his house. O Charmides, my master! since your property here is being torn to pieces in your absence, I wish I could see you return safe, that you might both take vengeance on your enemies, and give the reward to me according as I have behaved, and do behave towards you. ’Tis an extremely difficult thing for a friend to be found really such as the name imports, to whom, when you have entrusted your interests, you may sleep without any care. But lo! I perceive our son-in-law [86] coming, together with his neighbour. Something—what, I know not—is wrong between them. They are walking, each with a hasty step; the one is catching the other that is before him by the cloak.
They have come to a stop in no very courteous fashion. I’ll step aside here a little distance. I have a wish to hear the conversation of these two that are to be connected by marriage. ((He retires to a distance.))

((Enter LYSITELES and LESBONICUS.))

LYSITELES
Stay, this moment; don’t turn away, and don’t hide yourself from me. ((He catches hold of his cloak.))

LESBONICUS
((shaking him off))
Can’t you allow me to go whither I was proceeding?

LYSITELES
If, Lesbonicus, it seems to be to your interest, either for your glory or for your honour, I will let you go.

LESBONICUS
You are doing a thing that it is very easy to do.

LYSITELES
What is that?

LESBONICUS
An injury to a friend.

LYSITELES
It is no way of mine, and I have not learned so to do.

LESBONICUS
Untaught as you are, how cleverly you do it. What would you have done, if any one had taught you to be thus annoying to me? You, who, when you pretend to be acting kindly to me, use me ill, and are intending evil.

LYSITELES
What!—I?

LESBONICUS
Yes—you.

LYSITELES
How do I use you ill?

LESBONICUS
Inasmuch as you do that which I do not wish.

LYSITELES
I wish to consult your advantage.

LESBONICUS
Are you kinder to me than I am to myself? I have sense enough; I see sufficiently well those things that are for my own advantage.

LYSITELES
And is it having sense enough to refuse a kindness from a well-wisher?

LESBONICUS
I reckon it to be no kindness, when it does not please him on whom you are conferring it. I know, and I understand myself what I am doing, and my mind forsakes not its duty;
nor will I be driven by your speeches from paying due regard to my own character.

LYSITELES
What do you say? For now I cannot be restrained from saying to you the things which you deserve. Have your forefathers, I pray, so handed down this reputation to you, that you, by your excesses, might lose what before was gained by their merit, and that you might become a bar to the honour of your own posterity?
Your father and your grandfather made an easy and a level path for you to attain to honour; whereas you have made it to become a difficult one, by your extreme recklessness and sloth, and your besotted ways. You have made your election, to prefer your passions to virtue. Now, do you suppose that you can cover over your faults by these means? Alas! ’tis impossible.
Welcome virtue to your mind, if you please, and expel slothfulness from your heart. Give your attention to your he-friends in the Courts of justice [87] , and not to the couch of your she-friend, as you are wont to do. And earnestly do I now wish this piece of land to be left to you for this reason, that you may have wherewithal to reform yourself; so that those citizens, whom you have for enemies, may not be able altogether to throw your poverty in your teeth.

LESBONICUS
All these things which you have been saying, I know—could even set my seal [88] to them: how I have spoiled my patrimonial estate and the fair fame of my forefathers. I knew how it became me to live; to my misfortune I was not able to act accordingly. Thus, overpowered by the force of passion, inclined to ease, I fell into the snare; and now to you, quite as you deserve, I do return most hearty thanks.

LYSITELES
Still, I cannot suffer my labour to be thus lost, and yourself to despise these words; at the same time, it grieves me that you have so little shame. And, in fine, unless you listen to me, and do this that I mention, you yourself will easily lie concealed behind your own self, so that honour cannot find you; when you will wish yourself to be especially distinguished, you will be lying in obscurity.
I know right well, for my part, Lesbonicus, your highly ingenuous disposition; I know that of your own accord you have not done wrong, but that it is Love that has blinded your heart; and I myself comprehend all the ways of Love. As the charge of the balista [89] is hurled, so is Love; nothing is there so swift, or that so swiftly flies; he, too, makes the manners of men both foolish and froward [90] .
That which is the most commended pleases him the least [91] ; that from which he is dissuaded pleases him. When

there is a scarcity, then you long for a thing; when there is an abundance of it, then you don’t care for it. The person that warns him off from a thing, the same invites him; he that persuades him to it interdicts him. ’Tis a misfortune of insanity for you to fly to Cupid for refuge. But I advise you again and again to think of this, how you should seek to act.
If you attempt to do according as you are now showing signs [92] , you will cause the conflagration of your family; and then, in consequence, you will have a desire for water with which to quench this conflagration of your family. And if you should obtain it, just as lovers are subtle in their devices, you will not leave even one spark with which your family may brighten up.

LESBONICUS
’Tis easy to be found: fire is granted, even though you should ask it of a foe.
But you, by your reproof, are urging me from my faults to a viler course. You are persuading me to give you my sister without a portion. But it does not become me, who have misused so great a patrimony, to be still in affluent circumstances, and to be possessing land, but her to be in want, so as with good reason to detest me. Never will he be respected by others who makes himself despised by his own relatives.
As I said, I will do; I do not wish you to be in doubt any longer.

LYSITELES
And is it so much preferable that for your sister’s sake you should incur poverty, and that I should possess that piece of land rather than yourself, who ought to be upholding your own walls?

LESBONICUS
I do not wish you so much to have regard to myself, in order that you may relieve my poverty, as that in my neediness I may not become disgraced: that people may not spread about this report of me,
that I gave my own sister without a portion to you, rather in concubinage [93] than in marriage. Who would be said to be more dishonorable than I? The spreading of this report might do credit to you, but it would defile me, if you were to marry her without a portion. For you it would be a gain of reputation, for me it would be something for people to throw in my teeth.

LYSITELES
Why so? Do you suppose [94] that you will become Dictator if I accept the land of you?

LESBONICUS
I neither wish, nor require, nor do I think so; but still, to be mindful of his duty, is true honour to an upright man.

LYSITELES
For my part, I know you, how you are disposed in mind; I see it, I discover it, I apprehend. You are doing this, that when you have formed an alliance between us,
and when you have given up this piece of land, and have nothing here with which to support life, in beggary you may fly from the city, in exile you may desert your country, your kindred, your connexions, your friends,—the nuptials once over. People would suppose that you were frightened hence by my means, and through my cupidity. Do not fancy in your mind that I will act so as to allow that to happen.

STASIMUS
((advanccing.))
Well, I cannot but exclaim, Well done, well done, Lysiteles, encore [95] . Easily do you win the victory; the other is conquered: your performance is superior. This one ((pointing to LYSITELES)) acts better in character, and composes better lines [96] . By reason of your folly do you still dispute it? Stand in awe of the fine.

LESBONICUS
What means this interruption of yours, or your intrusion here upon our conversation?

STASIMUS
The same way that I came here I'll get me gone.

LESBONICUS
Step this way home with me, Lysiteles; there we will talk at length about these matters.

LYSITELES
I am not in the habit of doing anything in secret. Just as my feelings are I will speak out. If your sister, as I think it right, is thus given to me in marriage without a portion, and if you are not about to go away hence, that which shall be mine, the same shall be yours. But if you are minded otherwise, may that which you do turn out for you for the best. I will never be your friend on any other terms; such is my determination. ((Exit LESBONICUS, followed by LYSITELES.))

STASIMUS
Faith, he's off. D'ye hear—Lysiteles? I want you. He's off as well. Stasimus, you remain alone. What am I now to do, but to buckle up my baggage and sling my buckler on my back [97] ,
and order soles to be fastened [98] beneath my shoes? There is no staying now. I see that no long time hence I shall be a soldier's drudge. And when my master has thrown himself into the pay [99] of some potentate, I guess that among the greatest warriors he will prove a brave [100] —hand at running away, and that there he will capture the spoil, who-shall come to attack my master.
I myself, the moment that I shall have assumed my bow and quiver and arrows, and the helmet on my head, shall-go to sleep very quietly in my tent. I'll be off to the Forum; I'll ask that talent [101] back of the person to whom I lent it six days since, that I may have some provision for the journey to carry with me. ((Exit.))

((Enter MEGARONIDES and CALLICLES.))

MEGARONIDES
According as you relate the matter to me, Callicles, it really can by no means
be but that a portion must be given to the girl.

CALLICLES
Why, troth, it would hardly be honestly done on my part, if I were to allow her to contract a marriage without a portion, when I have her property in my possession at home.

MEGARONIDES
A portion is ready at your house; unless you like to wait
until her brother has disposed of her in marriage without a portion. After that, you might go to Philto yourself, and might say that you present her with a portion, and that you do it on account of your intimacy with her father. But I dread this, lest that offer might bring you into crimination and disgrace with the public.
They would say that you were so kind to the girl not without some good reason; that the dowry which you presented her was given you by her father; they would think that you were portioning her out of that, and that you had not kept it safe for her just as it was given, and that you had withheld some part. Now, if you wish to await the return of Charmides,
the time is very long; meanwhile, the inclination to marry her may leave this Lysiteles; this proposal, too, is quite a

first-rate one for her.

CALLICLES
All these very same things suggest themselves to my mind.

MEGARONIDES
Consider if you think this more feasible and more to the purpose: go to the young man himself, and tell him how the matter really stands.

CALLICLES
Should I now discover the treasure to a young man, ill-regulated, and brimful of passion and of wantonness? No, faith, most assuredly, by no means. For I know, beyond a doubt, that he would devour even all that spot where it is buried. I fear to dig for it, lest he should hear the noise;
lest, too, he might trace out the matter itself, if I should say I will give her a portion.

MEGARONIDES
By what method, then, can the portion be secretly taken out?

CALLICLES
Until an opportunity can be found for that business, I would, in the meanwhile, ask for a loan of the money from some friend or other.

MEGARONIDES
Can it be obtained from some friend or other?

CALLICLES
It can.

MEGARONIDES
Nonsense; you'll certainly meet with this answer at once: O, upon my faith, I really have not anything that I can lend you.

CALLICLES
Troth, I would rather they would tell me the truth than lend me the money with a bad grace.

MEGARONIDES
But consider this plan, if it pleases you.

CALLICLES
What is the plan?

MEGARONIDES
I have found out a clever plan, as I think.

CALLICLES
What is it?

MEGARONIDES

Let some person, now, be hired,
of an appearance as much unknown as possible, such as has not been often seen.
Let this person be dressed up to the life after a foreign fashion, just as though he were a foreigner.

CALLICLES
What is he to understand that he must do after that?

MEGARONIDES
It is necessary for him to be some lying,
deceiving, impudent fellow—a lounger from the Forum.

CALLICLES
And what then, after that?

MEGARONIDES
Let him come to the young man as though from Seleucia, from his father; let him pronounce his salutation to him in the words of his father, say that he is prospering in business, and is alive and well, and that he will be shortly coming back again. Let him bring two letters;
let us seal these, as though they are from his father. Let him give the one to him, and let him say that he wishes to give the other to yourself.

CALLICLES
Go on, and tell me still further.

MEGARONIDES
Let him say that he is bringing some gold as a marriage-portion from her father for the girl, and that his father has requested him to deliver it to you.
Do you understand me now?

CALLICLES
Pretty nearly; and I listen with great satisfaction.

MEGARONIDES
Then, in consequence, you will finally give the gold to the young man when the girl shall be given in marriage.

CALLICLES
Troth, ’tis very cleverly contrived.

MEGARONIDES
By this means, when you have dug up the treasure, you will have removed all cause for suspicion from the young man.
He will think that the gold has been brought to you from his father; whereas, you will be taking it from the treasure.

CALLICLES
Very cleverly and fairly contrived; although I am ashamed, at this time of life, for me to be playing a double part.
But when he shall bring the letters sealed, don’t you suppose that the young man will then
recollect the impression of his father’s signet [102] ?

MEGARONIDES
Will you be silent now? Reasons innumerable may be found for that circumstance. That which he used to have he has lost, and he has since had another new one made. Then, if he should bring them not sealed at all, this might be said,—that they had been unsealed for him by the custom-house officers [103] ,
and had been examined. On matters of this kind, however, ’tis mere idleness to spend the day in talk; although a long discussion might be spun out. Go now, at once, privately to the treasure; send to a distance the men-servants and the maids; and—do you hear?

CALLICLES
What is it?

MEGARONIDES
Take care that you conceal this matter from that same wife of yours as well; for, i’ faith, there is never any subject which they can be silent upon. Why are you standing now? Why don’t you take yourself off hence, and bestir yourself? Open the treasure, take thence as much gold as is requisite for this purpose; at once close it up again, but secretly,
as I have enjoined you; turn all out of the house.

CALLICLES
I will do so.

MEGARONIDES
But, really, we are continuing too long a discourse; we are wasting the day, whereas there is need now of all expedition. There is nothing for you to fear about the seal; trust me for that. This is a clever excuse to give, as I mentioned,
that they have been looked at by the officers. In fine, don’t you see the time of day? What do you think of him being of such a nature and disposition? He is drunk already; anything you like may be proved for him. Besides, what is the greatest point of all, this person will say that he brings, and not that he applies for, money.

CALLICLES
Now, that’s enough.

MEGARONIDES
I am now going to hire a sharper [104] from the Forum, and then I will seal the two letters; and I’ll send him thither ((pointing to the house of CHARMIDES)) , well tutored in his part, to this young man.

CALLICLES
I am going in-doors then to my duty in consequence. Do you see about this matter.

MEGARONIDES
I’ll take care it’s done in the very cleverest style. ((Exeunt.))

((Enter CHARMIDES.))

CHARMIDES
To Neptune, potent o’er the deep and most powerful, the brother of aethereal Jove, joyously and sincerely do I proffer praise, and return my grateful thanks; to the salt waves, too, with whom lay supreme power over

myself,—one, too, that existed over my property and my life, —inasmuch as from their realms they have returned me safe and sound even to my own native city. And, Neptune, before the other Deities, do I both give and return to you extreme thanks.
For all people talk of you as being cruel and severe, of voracious habits, filthy, unsightly, unendurable, and outrageous; on the other hand, I have experienced your kindly aid. For, in good sooth, I have found you mild and merciful upon the deep, even to that degree that I wished. This commendation, too, I had already heard with these ears before of you among men,—that you were accustomed to spare the poor, and to depress and overawe the rich. Adieu! I commend you; you know how to treat men properly, according as is just. This is worthy of the Gods; they should ever prove benignant to the needy; to men of high station, quite otherwise. Trusty have you proved, though they are in the habit of saying that you cannot be trusted. For, without you, it would have happened, I am very sure, that on the deep your attendants would have shockingly torn in pieces and rent asunder wretched me, and, together with me, my property as well, in every direction throughout the azure surface of ocean.
But just now, like raging dogs, and no otherwise, did the winds in hurricane beset the ship; storms and waves, and raging squalls were about to roar, to break the mast, to bear down the yards, to split the sails; had not your favouring kindness been nigh at hand. Have done with me, if you please; henceforth have I now determined to give myself up to ease; enough have I got. With what pains have I struggled, while I was acquiring riches for my son. But who is this [105] that is coming up the street with his new-fangled garb and appearance? I' faith, though I wish to be at home, I'll wait awhile; at the same time, I will give my attention to see what business this fellow is about. ((He retires aside.))

((Enter the SHARPER.))

A SHARPER.
To this day I give the name of The Festival of the Three Pieces (Trinummus); for, on this day, have I let out my services in a cheating scheme for three pieces of money.
I am just arrived from Seleucia, Macedonia, Asia, and Arabia,—places which I never visited either with my eye or with my foot. See now, what business poverty brings upon the man that is wretchedly destitute; inasmuch as I am now obliged, for the sake of three pieces of money, to say that I received these letters from a certain person, about whom I don't know,
nor have I ever known, who the man is, nor do I know this for certain, whether he was ever born or not.

CHARMIDES
((behind.))
Faith, this fellow's surely of the mushroom genus; he covers himself entirely with his top. [106] The countenance of the fellow appears to be Illyrian; he comes, too, in that garb.

A SHARPER.
He who hired me, when he had hired me, took me to his house; he told me what he wanted to be done; he taught and showed me beforehand
how I was to do everything. If, then, I should add anything more, my employer will on that account the better forward his plan through me. As he dressed me out, so am I now equipped; his money did that. He himself borrowed my costume, at his own risk, from the theatrical wardrobe [107] ; if I shall be able, now, to impose on this man through my garb,
I will give him occasion clearly to find that I am a very trickster.

CHARMIDES
((behind.))
The more I look at him, the less does the appearance of the fellow please me. 'Tis a wonder if that fellow there is

not either a night-robber [108] or a cutpurse. He is viewing the locality; he is looking around him and surveying the houses; troth, I think he is reconnoitring the spot for him to come and rob bye and bye.
I have a still greater desire to watch what he is about: I'll give attention to this matter.

A SHARPER.
This employer of mine pointed out these localities to me; at this house are my devices to be put in practice. I'll knock at the door.

CHARMIDES
((behind.))
Surely this fellow is making in a straight line for my house; i' faith, I think I shall have to keep watch this night of my arrival.

A SHARPER.
((knocks at the door of the house of CHARMIDES.))
Open this door!—open it! Hallo, there! who now has the care of this door [109] ?

CHARMIDES
((coming up to him.))
Young man, what do you want? hat is it you wish? Why are you knocking at this door?

A SHARPER.
Eh! old gentleman;
I am inquiring here for a young man named Lesbonicus, where in this quarter he lives —and likewise for another person, with such white hairs on his head as yours;
he that gave me these letters said his name was Callicles.

CHARMIDES
((aside.))
In fact, this fellow is looking for my own son Lesbonicus and my friend Callicles, to whom I entrusted both my children and my property.

A SHARPER.
Let me know, respected sir [110] , if you are acquainted with it, where these persons live.

CHARMIDES
Why are you inquiring for them? Or who are you?—Or whence are you?—Or whence do you cone?

A SHARPER.
I gave the return correctly to the Censor [111] , when I was questioned by him—

CHARMIDES

A SHARPER.
You ask a number of things in the same breath; I know not which in especial to inform you upon. If you will ask each thing singly, and in a quiet manner, I'll both let you know my name, and my business, and my travels.

CHARMIDES

I’ll do as you desire. Come then; in the first place, tell me your name.

A SHARPER.
You begin by demanding an arduous task.

CHARMIDES
How so?

A SHARPER.
Because, respected sir,
if you were to begin before daylight, i’ faith, to commence at the first part of my name [112] , ’twould be the dead of the night before you could get to the end of it.

CHARMIDES
According to your story, a person should have a long journey’s provision crammed tightly in for your name.

A SHARPER.
I have another name somewhat less,—about the size of a wine-casks [113] .

CHARMIDES
What is this name of yours, young man?

A SHARPER.
Hush, that’s my name [114] ;
that’s my every-day one.

CHARMIDES
I’ faith, ’tis a scampish name; just as though [115] you were to say, Hush, if I were confiding anything to you, and then it is at an end forthwith. ((Aside.)) This fellow is evidently a sharper. What say you, young man—?

A SHARPER.
What is it now?

CHARMIDES
Speak out; what do these persons owe you whom you are seeking?

A SHARPER.
The father of this young man, Lesbonicus, delivered to me these two letters;
he is a friend of mine.

CHARMIDES
((aside.))
I have now caught him in the fact; he says that I gave him the letters. I will have some fine sport with the fellow.

A SHARPER.
As I have begun, if you will give attention, I will say on.

CHARMIDES

I’ll give you my attention.

A SHARPER.
He bade me give this letter to his son, Lesbonicus, and this other one, as well, he bade me give to his friend Callicles.

CHARMIDES
((aside.))
Troth, but since he is acting the impostor, I, on the other hand, have an inclination to act the cheat as well. Where was he himself?

A SHARPER.
He was carrying on his business prosperously.

CHARMIDES
But where?

A SHARPER.
At Seleucia.

CHARMIDES
And did you receive these from himself?

A SHARPER.
With his own hands he himself delivered them into my hands.

CHARMIDES
Of what appearance is this person?

A SHARPER.
He is a person somewhere about half a foot taller than you.

CHARMIDES
((aside.))
This is an odd matter, if in fact I am taller when absent than when present.
Do you know this person?

A SHARPER.
You are asking me a ridiculous question; together with him I was in the habit of taking my meals.

CHARMIDES
What is his name?

A SHARPER.
One, i’ faith, that belongs to an honorable man.

CHARMIDES
I would like to hear it.

A SHARPER.
Troth, his name ((hesitating)) —his—his— ((Aside.)) Woe to unfortunate me.

CHARMIDES
What’s the matter?

A SHARPER.
Unguardedly, I this moment swallowed the name.

CHARMIDES
I like not the man that has his friends shut up within his teeth.

A SHARPER.
And yet this moment ’twas dwelling on the very edge of my lips.

CHARMIDES
((aside.))
I’ve come to-day in good time before this fellow.

A SHARPER.
((aside.))
To my sorrow I’m caught in the fact.

CHARMIDES
Have you now recollected the name?

A SHARPER.
’Fore Gods and men, i’ faith, I’m ashamed of myself

CHARMIDES
See, now, how well you know this man.

A SHARPER.
As well as my own self. This is in the habit of happening: the thing you are holding in your hand, and seeing with your eyes, that same you are looking for as lost. I’ll recollect it letter by letter. C is the beginning of the name.

CHARMIDES
Is it Callias?

A SHARPER.
No: it isn’t that.

CHARMIDES
Callippus?

A SHARPER.
It isn’t that.

CHARMIDES
Callidemides?

A SHARPER.
It isn’t that.

CHARMIDES
Callinicus?

A SHARPER.
No: it isn’t that.

CHARMIDES
Or is it Callimachus?

A SHARPER.
’Tis in vain you suggest; and, i’ faith, I really don’t care one fillip about it, since I recollect enough myself for my own purpose.

CHARMIDES
But there are many people here of the name of Lesbonicus; unless you tell me the name of his father,
I cannot show you these persons whom you are looking for. What is it like? Perhaps we can find it out by guessing.

A SHARPER.
It is something like this: Char—

CHARMIDES
Chares? Or Charicles? Or is it Charmides?

A SHARPER.
Ah! that’s he; may the Deities confound him.

CHARMIDES
I have said to you once before already that it is proper for you rather to speak well of a man that is your friend, than to curse him.

A SHARPER.
Isn’t it the fact [116] that this most worthless fellow has lain perdu between my lips and my teeth?

CHARMIDES
Don’t you be cursing an absent friend.

A SHARPER.
Why, then, did this most rascally fellow hide himself away from me?

CHARMIDES
If you had only called him, he would have answered to his name. But where is he himself now?

A SHARPER.
Troth, I left him at Rhadama [117] , in the isle of Apeland.

CHARMIDES

((aside.)) What person is there a greater simpleton than I, who myself am making inquiries where I am?
But it is by no means unimportant to this present purpose. What do you say as—?

A SHARPER.
What now?

CHARMIDES
I ask you this. [118] What places have you visited?

A SHARPER.
Places exceedingly wonderful in astonishing ways.

CHARMIDES
I should like to hear about them, unless it is inconvenient.

A SHARPER.
Really I quite long to tell you. First of all we were conveyed to Pontus, to the land of Arabia [119] .

CHARMIDES
How now; is Arabia then in Pontus?

A SHARPER.
It is. Not that Arabia where frankincense is produced,
but where the wormwood grows [120] , and the wild marjoram which the poultry love.

CHARMIDES
((aside.))
An extremely ingenious knave this. But the greater simpleton I, to be asking of this fellow from what place I have come back, a thing which I know, and he does not know; except that I have a mind to try how he will get out of it at last. But what say you further? Whither did you go next from thence?

A SHARPER.
If you give me your attention, I will tell you.
To the source of the river which arises out of the heavens, from beneath the throne of Jupiter.

CHARMIDES
Beneath the throne of Jupiter?

A SHARPER.
Yes: I say so.

CHARMIDES

Out of the heavens?

A SHARPER.
Aye, out of the very middle.

CHARMIDES
How now; and did you ascend even to the heavens?

A SHARPER.
Yes: we were carried in a little skiff [121] right on, up the river, against the tide.

CHARMIDES
And did you see Jupiter as well?

A SHARPER.
The other Gods said that he had gone to his country-house, to dole out the victuals for his slaves.
Then, after that—

CHARMIDES
Then after that—I don’t want you to relate anything more.

A SHARPER.
Troth, I’m silent, if it’s troublesome.

CHARMIDES
Why, no decent person [122] ought to tell it, who has gone from the earth to heaven.

A SHARPER.
I’ll leave you, as I see you wish it. But point me out these persons whom I am looking for, and to whom I must deliver these letters.

CHARMIDES
What say you? If now perchance you were to see Charmides himself, him, I mean, who you say gave you these letters, would you know the man?

A SHARPER.
By my troth now, do you take me to be a brute beast, who really am not able to recognise the person with whom I have been spending my life? And would he have been such a fool as to entrust to me a thousand
Philippean pieces, which gold he bade me carry to his son, and to his friend Callicles, to whom he said that he had entrusted his affairs? Would he have entrusted them to me if he had not known me, and I him, very intimately?

CHARMIDES
((aside.))
I really have a longing now to swindle this swindler, if I can cozen him out of these thousand Philippean pieces which he has said that I have given to him. A person, that I know not who he is, and have never beheld him with my eyes before this day, should I be entrusting gold to him? A man, to whom, if his life were at stake, I would not entrust a dump of lead. This fellow must be adroitly dealt with by me. Hallo! Mister Hush, I want three words with you.

A SHARPER.
Even three hundred, if you like.

CHARMIDES
Have you that gold which you received from Charmides?

A SHARPER.
Yes, and Philippeans, too, counted out on the table with his own hand, a thousand pieces.

CHARMIDES
You received it, you mean, from Charmides himself?

A SHARPER.
'Twere a wonder if I had received it of his father, or of his grandfather, who are dead.

CHARMIDES
Then, young man, hand me over this gold.

A SHARPER.
((staring at him.))
What gold am I to give you?

CHARMIDES
That which you have owned you received from me.

A SHARPER.
Received from you?

CHARMIDES
Yes, I say so.

A SHARPER.
Who are you?

CHARMIDES
I am Charmides, who gave you the thousand pieces of money.

A SHARPER.
I' faith, you are not he; and this day, you never shall be he, for this gold, at any rate. Away with you, if you please, you impostor! ((Aside.)) You are trying to cheat the cheater.

CHARMIDES
I am Charmides.

A SHARPER.
I' faith, you are so to no purpose, for I carry [123] no gold. Right cleverly were you down upon me, at the very nick of time.

After I said that I was bringing the gold, that instant you became Charmides. Before I made mention of the gold, you were not he. It won’t do. Just, therefore, in such manner as you Charmidised yourself, do you again un-Charmidise yourself.

CHARMIDES
Who am I, then, if in fact I am not he who I really am?

A SHARPER.
What matters that to me? So long as you are not he whom I do not choose you to be, you may be who you like, for what I care.
Just now, you were not he who you were, now you are become he who then you were not.

CHARMIDES
Come, despatch, if you are going to do it.

A SHARPER.
What am I to do?

CHARMIDES
Give me back the gold.

A SHARPER.
You are dreaming, old gentleman.

CHARMIDES
Did you own that Charmides delivered the gold to you?

A SHARPER.
Yes—in writing [124] .

CHARMIDES
Are you making haste or not, you night-robber, to be off with all speed this very instant from this neighbourhood, before I order you to be soundly cudgelled on the spot?

A SHARPER.
For what reason?

CHARMIDES
Because I am that self-same Charmides about whom you have been thus lying, and who you said gave the letters to you.

A SHARPER.
How now; prithee, are you really he?

CHARMIDES
I really am he.

A SHARPER.

Say you so, pray? Are you really he himself?

CHARMIDES
I do say so.

A SHARPER.
Are you his own self?

CHARMIDES
His own self, I say. I am Charmides.

A SHARPER.
And are you then his own self?

CHARMIDES
His own very self. Begone hence out of my sight.

A SHARPER.
Since you really have made your appearance here thus late,
you shall be beaten both at my own award [125] and that of the new Aediles.

CHARMIDES
And are you abusing me as well?

A SHARPER.
Yes; seeing that you have arrived in safety [126] , may the Gods confound me, if I care a straw for you, had you perished first. I have received the money for this job; you, I devote to bad luck. But who you are, or who you are not, I care not one jot.
I'll go and carry word [127] to him who gave me the three pieces, that he may know that he has thrown them away. I'm off. Live with a curse, and fare you ill; may all the Gods confound you, Charmides, for coming from abroad [128] . ((Exit.))

CHARMIDES
Since this fellow has gone, at last a time and opportunity seem to have arrived for speaking out without restraint. Already does this sting pierce my breast—what business he could have before my house? For these letters summon apprehensions into my heart; those thousand pieces, too—what purpose they were to serve. I' faith, a bell [129] is never rung for no purpose;
unless some one handles it or moves it, 'tis mute, 'tis dumb. But who is this, that is beginning to run this way along the street? I should like to observe what he is about. I'll step aside this way. ((He retires aside.))

((Enter STASIMUS.))

STASIMUS
((to himself.))
Stasimus, make you haste with all speed; away with you to your master's house, lest on a sudden, through your folly, fears should arise for your shoulder-blades [130] .
Quicken your pace, make haste; 'tis now a long while since you left the house. If you shall be absent when inquired after by your master, take you care, please, that the smacks of the bull's-hide [131] don't clatter thick

upon you. Don’t you cease running. See now, Stasimus, what a worthless fellow you are; and isn’t it the fact that you have forgotten your ring [132] at the liquor- shop [133] after you have been washing your throat with warm drink?
Turn about, and run back now, to seek it, while the thing has but just happened.

CHARMIDES
((behind.))
Whoever he is, his throat is his taskmaster [134] ; that teaches this fellow the art of running.

STASIMUS
What, good-for-nothing fellow, are you not ashamed of yourself? having lost your memory after only three cups? And really, because you were there drinking together with such honest fellows, who could keep their hands off [135] the property of another without difficulty;
—is it among such men that you expect you may recover your ring?
Chiruchus was there, Cerconicus, Crimnus, Cricolabus, Collabus [136] , whipped-necks [137] , whipped-legs, iron-rubbers, whipped-knaves.
By my faith, any one of these could steal the sole of his shoe from a running footman [138] .

CHARMIDES
((behind.))
So may the Gods love me, a finished thief.

STASIMUS
Why should I go seek what is gone for ever?
Unless I would bestow my pains, too, by way of addition over and above to my loss. Why, then, don’t you consider that what is gone is gone? Tack about, then [139] . Betake yourself back to your master.

CHARMIDES
((behind.))
This fellow is no runaway; he remembers his home.

STASIMUS
I wish that the old-fashioned ways of old-fashioned days, and the old-fashioned thriftiness, were in greater esteem here, rather than these bad ways.

CHARMIDES
((behind.))
Immortal Gods! this man really is beginning to talk of noble doings! He longs for the old-fashioned ways; know that he loves the old-fashioned ways, after the fashion of our forefathers.

STASIMUS
For, now-a-days, men’s manners reckon of no value what is proper, except what is agreable. Ambition now is sanctioned by usage, and is free from the laws. By usage, people have the license to throw away their shields, and to run away from the enemy.
To seek honor thereby in place of disgrace is the usage.

CHARMIDES
((behind.))

A shameless usage.

STASIMUS
Now-a-days, ’tis the usage to neglect the brave.

CHARMIDES
((behind.))
Aye, ’tis really shocking.

STASIMUS
The public manners have now got the laws in their power; to them they are more submissive than are parents to their children [140] . In their misery, these laws are even hung up [141] against the wall with iron nails, where it had been much more becoming for bad ways to be fixed up.

CHARMIDES
((behind.))
I’d like to go up and accost this person; but I listen to him with much pleasure, and I’m afraid, if I address him, that he may begin to talk on some other subject.

STASIMUS
And, for these ways, there is nothing rendered sacred by the law. The laws are subservient to usage; but these habits are hastening to sweep away both what is sacred and what is public property.

CHARMIDES
((behind.))
By my troth, ’twere right for some great calamity to befal these bad customs.

STASIMUS
Ought not this state of things to be publicly censured? For this kind of men are the enemies of all persons, and do an injury to the entire people. By a non-observance of their own honour, they likewise destroy all trust even in those who merit it not; inasmuch as people form an estimate of the disposition of these from the disposition of those fellows.
If you lend [142] a person any money, it becomes lost for any purpose as one’s own. When you ask for it back again, you may find a friend made an enemy by your kindness. If you begin to press still further, the option of two things ensues—either you must part with that which you have entrusted, or else you must lose that friend.
As to how this suggests itself to me, I have by actual experience been lately put in mind of it.

CHARMIDES
((behind.))
Surely this is my servant Stasimus?

STASIMUS
For as to him to whom I lent the talent, I bought myself an enemy with my talent, and sold my friend. But I am too great a simpleton to be attending to public matters rather than (what’s my immediate interest) obtain safety for my back. I’ll go home. ((Moves as if going.))

CHARMIDES
Hallo, you! Stop, this instant! Harkye; hallo, you!

STASIMUS
I’ll not stop.

CHARMIDES
I want you.

STASIMUS
What if I myself don’t want you to want me.

CHARMIDES
Why, Stasimus, you are behaving very rudely.

STASIMUS
’Twere better for you to buy some one to give your commands to.

CHARMIDES
I’ faith, I have bought one, and paid the money, too. But if he is not obedient to my orders, what ani I to do?

STASIMUS
Give him a severe punishment.

CHARMIDES
You give good advice; I am resolved to do so.

STASIMUS
Unless, indeed, you are under obligations to him.

CHARMIDES
If he is a deserving person, I am under obligations to him; but if he is otherwise, I’ll do as you advise me.

STASIMUS
What matters it to me whether you have good or bad slaves?

CHARMIDES
Because you have a share in this matter both of the good and of the bad.

STASIMUS
The one share I leave to yourself; the other share, that in the good, do you set down [143] to my account.

CHARMIDES
If you shall prove deserving, it shall be so. Look back at me—I am Charmides.

STASIMUS
Ha! what person is it that has made mention of that most worthy man?

CHARMIDES
’Tis that most worthy man himself.

STASIMUS
O seas, earth, heavens, by my trust in you—do I see quite clearly with my eyes? Is this he, or is it not? ’Tis he! ’Tis certainly he; ’tis he beyond a doubt! O my most earnestly wished-for master, health to you!

CHARMIDES
Health to you, too, Stasimus!

STASIMUS
That you are safe and sound, I—

CHARMIDES
((interruptitng him.))
I know it, and I believe you. But wave the rest; answer me this; how are my children,
my son and daughter, whom I left here?

STASIMUS
They are alive, and well.

CHARMIDES
Both of them, say you?

STASIMUS
Both of them.

CHARMIDES
The Gods willed me to be safe and preserved from dangners. The rest that I want to know I will inquire about in-doors at my leisure. Let us go in-doors; follow me.

STASIMUS
Where are you going now?

CHARMIDES
Where else but to my house?

STASIMUS
Do you suppose that we are living here?

CHARMIDES
Why, where else should I suppose?

STASIMUS
Now—

CHARMIDES
What about now?

STASIMUS

This house is not our own.

CHARMIDES
What is it I hear from you?

STASIMUS
Your son has sold this house.

CHARMIDES
I’m ruined.

STASIMUS
For silver minae; ready money counted out.

CHARMIDES
How many?

STASIMUS
Forty.

CHARMIDES
I’m undone. Who has purchased it?

STASIMUS
Callicles, to whom you entrusted your affairs; he has removed here to live, and has turned us out of doors.

CHARMIDES
Where is my son now living?

STASIMUS
Here, in these back buildings. ((Points to the side of the house.))

CHARMIDES
I’m utterly undone.

STASIMUS
I thought that this would be distressing to you when you heard of it.

CHARMIDES
To my sorrow, amid extreme dangers I have been borne over vast oceans, with the peril of my life I have preserved myself among robbers full many in number, and I have returned safe. Now, to my misery, I am here undone by reason of those same persons for whose sake I have been struggling at this time of life Grief is depriving me of my senses. Support me, Stasimus.

STASIMUS
Do you wish me to fetch you some water?

CHARMIDES

When my fortunes were in their mortal struggle, then was it befitting that water should be sprinkled [144] upon them.

((Enter CALLICLES.))

CALLICLES
What noise is this that I hear before my house?

CHARMIDES
O Callicles! O Callicles! O Callicles!
to what sort of friend have I entrusted my property?

CALLICLES
To one good, and faithful, and trusty, and of strict integrity. Health to you, and I rejoice that you have arrived safe and sound [145] .

CHARMIDES
How, health to me? Troth, I have no patience with such health. This I wish to know; how have you kept your trust, who, without my knowledge, have utterly destroyed my property and my children that I entrusted to you and committed to your charge when going hence abroad?

CALLICLES
I don’t think that it is fair, when you don’t understand the matter, to censure your old friend with harsh words. For you are both mistaken and you are doing me a very great injustice.

CHARMIDES
Have you not bought this house which you came out of just now, and driven thence my son Lesbonicus? Is this so as I say, or is it not? Answer me.

CALLICLES
I myself did buy the house; I bought it that I might keep it for you. And without that it would have happened that your son would have sold it to another person; and then you would have lost both it and that treasure together, which, concealed there, you had entrusted to my charge. See, I restore it safe to you; for you did I buy it, not for myself.

CHARMIDES
Prithee, what do you say? By my trust in Gods and men, you make me suddenly to be quite ashamed of my error in speaking unkindly to my friend in return for his services.

CALLICLES
How, then; do you now think that I am trusty and faithful?

CHARMIDES
I do think so, if all these matters are so as you relate them. But what means [146] this garb of yours?

CALLICLES
I’ll tell you.
I was digging up the treasure indoors, as a marriage-portion to be given to your daughter. But I will relate to you

both this and the rest in the house. Follow me.

CHARMIDES
Stasimus.

STASIMUS
Well!

CHARMIDES
Run with all haste to the Piraeus [147] , and make but one run of it. There you will at once see the ship, on board of which I was carried hither.
Bid Sagario take care that the things are brought which I enjoined him, and do you go together with them. The duty has been already paid [148] to the custom-house officer.

STASIMUS
I make no delay. [149]

CHARMIDES
Get you gone with all speed; and be back directly.

STASIMUS
I am both there and here in an instant.

CALLICLES
((to CHARMIDES.))
Do you follow me this way indoors.

CHARMIDES
I follow. ((Exeunt CALLICLES and CHARMIDES into the house.))

STASIMUS
This man alone has remained a firm friend to my master; nor has he allowed his mind to swerve from unshaken fidelity, although I believe that he has undergone many troubles, by reason of the property and the children of my master. Still, this person, as I suspect, alone has maintained his fidelity. ((Exit.))

((Enter LYSITELES.))

LYSITELES
This individual [150] is the very first of all men; excelling all in pleasures and delights. So truly do the blessings which I desire befal me, that whatever I undertake is brought about, and constantly succeeds: so does one delight succeed other delights.
Just now, Stasimus, the servant of Lesbonicus, came to me at home. He told me that his master, Charmides, had arrived here from abroad. Now he must be forthwith waited upon by me, that the father may prove a more sure foundation in that matter on which I have treated with his son. I’ll go. But this door, with its creaking, inopportunely causes me delay. ((He retires to a distance.))

((Enter CHARMIDES and CALLICLES.))

CHARMIDES
There never was, nor will there be, nor yet do I think that there is a person upon the earth, whose fidelity and constancy towards his friend equals yours. For without you, it would have been that he would have ousted me out of this house.

CALLICLES
If I have in any way acted well towards my friend, or have faithfully consulted his advantage, I seem not to be deserving of praise, but I think I am free from fault.
For a benefit which is conferred on a man for his own, at once is lost to the giver; what is given only as a loan, the same there is a right to ask back, whenever you please.

CHARMIDES
’Tis so as you say. But I cannot sufficiently-wonder at this, that he has betrothed his sister into a family so influential.

CALLICLES
Aye; to Lysiteles, the son of Philto.

LYSITELES
((behind.))
Why, he is mentioning my name.

CHARMIDES
He has got into a most worthy family.

LYSITELES
((behind.))
Why do I hesitate to address these persons? But still, I think, I may wait awhile; for something is going to be said to the purpose about this matter.

CHARMIDES
O—

CALLICLES
What’s the matter?

CHARMIDES
I forgot just now to tell you of it in-doors. As I was coming hither, a while ago, a certain swindling fellow met me—a very finished sharper. He told me that he was carrying a thousand gold pieces,
of my giving, to you and my son Lesbonicus; a fellow, that I know not who he was, nor have I ever seen him anywhere before. But why do you laugh?

CALLICLES
He came by my directions, as though he was one bringing the gold from you to me, to give as a portion to your daughter; that your son, when I should give it to her from my own hands, might suppose that it had been brought from you,
and that he might not anyhow be enabled to discover the fact itself—that your treasure was in my possession, and demand it of me [151] , as having belonged to his father, by the public laws.

CHARMIDES
Cleverly contrived, i’ troth.

CALLICLES
Megaronides, a common well-wisher of yours and mine, planned this.

CHARMIDES
Well, I applaud his device, and approve of it.

LYSITELES
((behind.))
Why, in my foolishness, while I fear to interrupt their discourse,
am I standing here alone, and am not forwarding the business that I was intending to transact? I will accost these persons. ((He advances.))

CHARMIDES
Who is this person that is coming this way towards us?

LYSITELES
((going up to CHARMIDES.))
Lysiteles salutes his father-in-law Charmides.

CHARMIDES
May the Gods grant you, Lysiteles, whatever you may desire.

CALLICLES
Am I not worthy of a salutation?

LYSITELES
Yes; health to you, Callicles. It is right that I should give him the preference: the tunic is nearer [152] the skin than the cloak.

CALLICLES
I trust that the Gods may direct your plans aright.

CHARMIDES
I hear that my daughter has been betrothed to you?

LYSITELES
Unless you are unwilling.

CHARMIDES
Nay, I am not unwilling.

LYSITELES
Do you, then, promise your daughter for my wife?

CHARMIDES
I promise a thousand gold Philippean pieces, as well, for a portion.

LYSITELES
I care nothing about a portion.

CHARMIDES
If she pleases you, the portion which she presents to you must be pleased as well.
In fine, the object which you desire you shall not have, unless you shall take that which you do not desire.

CALLICLES
((to LYSITELES.))
He asks but justice.

LYSITELES
He shall obtain it, you the advocate and the judge. On these conditions, do you engage that your daughter shall be given to me as my wife?

CHARMIDES
I do promise her.

CALLICLES
And I promise her likewise.

LYSITELES
O save you, my connexions by marriage. ((He embraces them.))

CHARMIDES
But, in good sooth, there are some matters on account of which I still am angry with you.

LYSITELES
What have I done?

CHARMIDES
Because you have allowed my son to become dissolute.

LYSITELES
Had that been done by my consent, there would have been cause for you to blame me. But allow me to obtain of you this one thing which I entreat?

CHARMIDES
What is it?

LYSITELES
You shall know. If he has done anything imprudently, that you will dismiss it all from your mind. Why do you shake your head?

CHARMIDES

My heart is tortured, and I fear—

LYSITELES
What is it now?

CHARMIDES
Because he is such as I would that he was not,—by that am I tortured. I fear that if I refuse you what you ask of me, you may suppose that I am indifferent towards you. I won’t make difficulties, however; I will do as you wish.

LYSITELES
You are a worthy man. I am going to call him out. ((He goes to the door of the house of CHARMIDES)) .

CHARMIDES
’Tis a shocking thing if one is not allowed to punish bad deserts just as they merit.

LYSITELES
((knocking at the door.))
Open the door, open quickly, and call Lesbonicus out of doors, if he is at home.
The occasion is very sudden, therefore I wish him to come to me with all haste.

LESBONICUS
((Enter LESBONICUS from the house.))
What person has been calling me out of doors with so loud a knocking?

LYSITELES
’Tis your well.wisher and friend

LESBONICUS
Is all quite right?—tell me.

LYSITELES
All’s well. I am glad to say that your father has returned from abroad.

LESBONICUS
Who says so?

LYSITELES
I.

LESBONICUS
Have you seen him?

LYSITELES
Aye, and you yourself may see him too. ((He points to CHARMIDES.))

LESBONICUS
O my father, my father, blessings on you.

CHARMIDES
Many blessings on you, my son.

LESBONICUS
If, father, any trouble [153] —

CHARMIDES
Have no fear, nothing has happened. My affairs prosperously managed, I have returned safe. If you are only wishful to be steady, that daughter of Callicles has been promised you.

LESBONICUS
I will marry both her, father, and any one else besides that you shall bid me.

CHARMIDES
Although I have been angry with you,
one misery [154] , in fact, is more than enough for one man.

CALLICLES
Nay, rather, ’twere too little for him; for if he were to marry a hundred wives for his sins, it were too little.

LESBONICUS
But henceforth, in future, I will be steady.

CHARMIDES
So you say; if you will only do it.

LESBONICUS
Is there any reason why I should not bring my wife home to-morrow?

CHARMIDES
’Tis very good. And you, Lysiteles, be ready to be married the day after to-morrow.

A COMEDIAN
Give your applause [155] .

NOTES

[1] [Supposed to have been written by Priscian the Grammarian.]

[2] The Prologue : This Prologue is one of the few figurative ones to be found in the Comedies of Plautus. He appropriately represents Luxury as introducing her daughter Poverty to the abode of the dissipated Lesbonicus. Claudian has a somewhat similar passage in his poem to Rufinus: Et Luxus, populator opum, cui, semper adhaerens, Infelix humili gressu comitatur Egestas. And Luxury, the waster of wealth, whom, ever attending, wretched Poverty accompanies with humble step. It has been justly observed, that Plautus here avoids a fault which he often falls into, of acquainting the audience with too much of the plot.

[3] Philemon wrote it : Not only Philemon, but Menander also, wrote a play, entitled the Treasure.

[4] In Latin : Barbare We learn from Festus, and other authors, that the Greeks were in the habit of calling all nations, without exception, but themselves, barbarians. Hence the present expression, which literally meant into barbarous language.

[5] Household God : Literally, Lar. The Lares were the household Gods, or tutelary Deities of each family. The figures of them were kept, among the Romans, near the hearth, in the Lararium which was a recess formed for that purpose, and in which prayers were offered up on rising in the morning. There were both public and private Lares. The latter were by some thought to have been identical with the Manes, or shades, of the ancestors of the family occupying the house. The public Lares were the Urbani, presiding over the cities; Rustici, over the country; Compitales, over crossroads; and Marini, over the sea. Varro tells us that there were 265 stations for the statues of the Lares at the corner of the streets of Rome . Lar was an Etrurian word, signifying noble, or lord. The Greeks adorned their household Gods with the leaves of the plane-tree, the Romans with ears of corn. This was especially done on entering a new house, on which the wish was expressed that it might turn out prosperous, lucky, happy, and fortunate to the new occupants. Quod bonum, faustum, felix, fortunatumque sit. Callicles here expresses this wish on taking possession of the house which he has just bought of Lesbonicus.

[6] Wife : Being at the door of his house, before shutting it, he calls to his wife within. His kind wish as to the duration of her life he expresses just as he shuts the door.

[7] Has become a child : He means to say that he has become a boy from the fact of his being in need of correction.

[8] And i’ faith : Hercle, by Hercules; Ecastor, by Castor, Edepol, by Pollux, or by the temple of Pollux, and Pol, by Pollux, were the every-day oaths in the mouths of the Romans, and were used for the purpose of adding weight to the asseverations of the speaker. A literal translation of them throughout this work would hardly be in accordance with the euphony required by the English ear. They are therefore rendered throughout by such expressions as i’ faith, troth, by my troth, etc.

[9] Indeed I fancy : Neque, which implies a negative, seems to be more in accordance with the sense of the passage than the affirmative nempe, which is the reading of Ritschel; it has therefore been adopted.

[10] Not to be knowing : That is, the risk you would run in taking her or your wife.

[11] Just as one lives : The meaning of this passage seems to be somewhat obscure, and many of the Editions give this line to Megaronides. It is probable however, that Callicles intends, as a consolation for them both, to say that life itself is a blessing, and that they ought not by unnecessary anxieties to shorten it, but rather to submit with patience to their domestic grievances.

[12] In the Capitol : Plautus does not much care about anachronism or dramatic precision; though the plot of the play is derived from the Greek, and the scene laid at Athens , he makes frequent reference to Roman localities and manners. It is probable that the expression here employed was proverbial at Rome , to signify a deed of daring and unscrupulous character. From ancient writers we learn that there was a statue of Jupiter seated in a chariot, placed on the roof of the Capitoline Temple. Tarquinius Priscus employed Etrurian artists to make a statue of pottery for this purpose; and the original chariot, with its four horses, was made of baked clay. In later and more opulent times, the crown placed on the statue was of great value, so much so as to act as a temptation to one Petilius, who attempted to steal it, and being caught in the fact, was afterwards nicknamed Capitolinus. Mention is again made of this status in the Menaechmi, act v, sc. b. l. 38.

[13] Greedy of grovelling gain : Plautus makes this into one word turpilucricupidum. Probably it was used as a nickname for avaricious persons. It is here attempted to be expressed by an alliteration. Thornton renders it Gripeall.

[14] A vulture : Both on account of the sordid and greedy habits of that bird, and because, as is stated in the next line, it cares not which side supplies its maw when it follows the course of contending armies.

[15] Hence to Seleucia : There were several cities of this name. The one in Syria , a maritime city on the Orontes, near Antioch , is probably here referred to.

[16] Forty minae : Unless he adds the adjective aurea, golden, Plautus always means silver minae. The mina was the sixtieth part of the Attic talent, and contained one hundred drachmae, of about ninepence three-farthings each.

[17] Of Philippean pieces : These were gold coins much in circulation throughout Greece , struck by Philip, King of Macedon .

[18] Advertised with bills : The method among the Romans of letting, or selling houses, was similar to ours. A ball was fixed upon the house, or some conspicuous place near it, inscribed with Aedes locandae, This house to be lot, or Aedes vendundae, This house for sale.

[19] He watched till : He alludes to the conduct of Lesbonicus, who watched for the absence of his guardian, Callicles, that he might sell the house. This he would attempt to do, probably, on the plea that his father, not having been heard of for a long time, must be presumed to be dead, and the house has consequently descended to him, as his heir

[20] The back part : Posticulum probably means detached buildings at the back of the house, and within the garden walls, which adjoin the posticum or posticula, the back door or garden-gate.

[21] Call Busybodies : The word Scurra, which is here rendered busybody, originally meant a fellow-townsman, well to do in life, and a pleasant companion. In time, however, the word came to have a bad signification attached to it, and to mean an idle fellow, who did nothing but go about cracking his jokes at the expense of others, gossiping, and mischief-making, and at last to signify a clown, buffoon, or mimic on the stage. These men are most probably termed here assidui, everlasting gossipers, from a habit which many people have of making frequent calls on their neighbours, sitting down, and never thinking of taking their departure till they have exhausted all their stock of evil-speaking, lying, and slandering. Gossiping was notoriously the propensity of the Athenians. Numbers did nothing but saunter about the city, and go from spot to spot, with the question ti kainoe, Any news? Few will fail to remember the censure of them in the Seventeenth chapter of the Acts of the Apostles, v. 21: For all the Athenians and strangers which were there spent their time in nothing else, but either to tell, or to hear some new thing.

[22] They do not know : That is, who only pretend to know.

[23] That enjoins a hard task : Exercitor means the instructor or training master in the Gymnastic exercises. Of course, to beginners, the exercitores would be hard task-masters.

[24] A rapacious grappler : — Harpago means either a grappling-iron or a flesh-hook. It was often made in the form of a hand, with the fingers bent inwards. The grappling-iron was used to throw at the enemy’s ship, where it

seized the rigging and dragged the vessel within reach, so that it might be easily boarded and destroyed. Cupid is so called here, figuratively, from his insidious approaches, and the difficulty which his victims have in shaking him off

[25] Give me this thing : This is supposed to be pronounced in a mincing or affected way, to imitate the wheedling manners of the frail tempter.

[26] While he is wavering : Literally, she strikes him as he hangs. Lindemann seems to think that there is a play upon the word pendentem, which would apply either to the slave, who, according to the barbarous custom of the Romans, was lashed as he hung from the hook to which he was fastened by the hands, or to the lover who is hesitating between assent and refusal; on which she, by her artfulness— ferit — strikes the decisive blow. Terence has the expression ferior munere, to strike with a present.

[27] A thing that creates : This passage is here read with a period after comest, and not after sumpti, as Ritschel's edition has it. This seems more agreeable to the sense of the passage, which is, however, probably in a corrupt state.

[28] Wardrobe-woman : The duty of the vestiplica would be to fold up and try the clothes of her mistress. These slaves were also called vestispicae, and servants a veste.

[29] A perfume-keeper : The unctor was probably a male slave, whose duty it was to procure and keep the perfumes and unguents for his mistress.

[30] Fan-bearers : Both male and female slaves, and eunuchs, were employed to fan their mistresses. The fans were of elegant form and beautiful colours, and were frequently made of peacocks' feathers, being of a stiff shape, and not pliable, like ours. They were used both for the purpose of cooling the air and driving away flies and gnats.

[31] Sandal-bearers : The sandal was often one of the most costly articles of the female dress, being much adorned with embroidery and gold. Originally it was worn by both sexes and consisted of a wooden sole, fastened with thongs to the foot. In latter times, its use was confined to females, and a piece of leather covered the toes, while thongs, elegantly decorated, were attached to it. From the present passage it appears that it was the duty of a particular slave to take charge of sandals.

[32] Casket- keepers : The cistellatrix probably had charge of the jewel casket of her mistress. The present passage shows in what affluence and splendour some of the courtesans lived in those days.

[33] Avoids the Courts : Shakspeare has a somewhat similar passage in Romeo and Juliet: But all so soon as the all cheering sun Should in the furthest East begin to draw The shady curtains from Aurora's bed, Away from light steals home my heavy son, And private in his chamber pens himself, Shuts up his windows, locks fair daylight out, And mates himself an artificial night.

[34] Keep your own : This is as much as to say, I divorce myself from you, and utterly repudiate you. The words tuas res tibi habeto were the formula solemnly pronounced among the Romans by the husband in cases of divorce, when he delivered back to the wife her own separate property.

[35] To the dead : Ad plures, to the many, signifies the dead, inasmuch as they are more in number than the living. It was probably used as a euphemism, as to make mention of death was considered ominous of ill. Homen in the Odyssey, uses tous pe eionas in a similar sense

[36] Where vice was the order of the day : Damni conciliabulum. Literally, the place of counsel for wickedness.

[37] In due preservation : Buildings were said to be sarta tecta, in good repair, when the roof was proof against rain. The expression is here used figuratively, to signify, I have punctually observed your injunctions.

[38] Is nearly past : It is worthy of remark that this line is quoted by Cicero in his second Epistle to Brutus: Sed de hoc tu videris. De me possum dicere idem quod Plautinus pater in Trinummo, mihi quidem aetas acta ferme est. As for that matter, it is your concern. For my own part, I may say with the father in the Trinummus of Plautus, my life is nearly past

[39] Keep on overlaying : Philto is most probably alluding to the metaphorical expression, sarta tecta, used just before by his son; and he tells him that the only way to keep rain from coming in at the roof (that is, to keep evil thoughts out of the mind) is to overlay one good deed with another, just as tile is laid upon tile.

[40] With public business : He means by this expression, has he been farming the taxes or the public lands? which of course would be a pursuit attended with considerable risk.

[41] By just as many letters : Commentators differ as to the meaning of this passage, which is somewhat obscure. Philto seems to say that shame before doing an unwise action is every way preferable to repentance after having done it; preferable, indeed, by each individual letter it is composed of, or, as we should say in common parlance, every inch of it.

[42] Niggardly citizen : Immunis means one that does not bear his share in the taxes and tribute of the state, or, in other words, pay his scot and lot. Hence, with an extended signification, it means one that will not out of his abundance assist the distress of others, and who is, consequently, a niggardly and covetous person.

[43] Truly niggardly man : Philto here alludes to the primary meaning of the word immunis; and hints that it may be more properly applied to Lesbonicus, who has reduced himself to poverty by his extravagance, than to himself; inasmuch as he is now perforce immunis, not having wherewithal to pay the public dues and taxes.

[44] What he had not : That is, by the dishonest expedient of running to debt for it.

[45] Washed away in baths : This will probably refer, not to the money paid for mere bathing at the public baths, which was a quadrans , the smallest Roman coin, but to the expense of erecting private baths, which generally formed a portion of the luxuries of a Roman house. The public baths, however, may have possibly been the scene of much profligacy, and have afforded to the reckless and dissipated ample opportunities for squandering their money. That this may have been the fact, is rendered the more likely when we consider the equivocal signification of the word bagnio .

[46] Make all due deductions : Si sumas. Literally, if you subtract.

[47] The money’s gone : Instead of a Latin word, the Greek oichetai is introduced, which means is gone, or has vanished. Greek terms were current at Rome , just as French words and sentences are imported into our language; indeed, the fashions of Rome were very generally set by the Greeks.

[48] Has sold his house : He feels satisfied now that Lysiteles has been correctly informed, and that Lesbonicus really is in difficulties.

[49] The beggar’s gate : He probably alludes to the Porta Trigemina at Rome , which was upon the road to Ostia . It received its name from the three twin-born brothers, the Horatii, who passed beneath it when going to fight the Curiatii. This, being one of the largest and most frequented roads in Rome , was especially the resort of mendicants; among whom, in the opinion of Philto, the father of Lesbonicus will have to take his place. Some Commentators would read ponte instead of portâ, and they think that the allusion is to the Sublician bridge at Rome , where we learn from Seneca and Juvenal that the beggars used to sit and ask alms.

[50] His son’s stomach : He satirically alludes to the reckless conduct of Lesbonicus, who has spent everything to satisfy his love for eating, drinking, and debauchery.

[51] Olympic drachmae : As already mentioned, the drachma was about ninepence three-farthings in value. As one hundred made a mina, one fourth of the price received for the house would go to satisfy the banker’s claim.

[52] To the banker : The Trapezitae were the same as the Argentarii at Rome , who were bankers and money-changers on their own account, while the Mensarii transacted business on behalf of the state. Their shops, or offices, were situate around the Forum, and were public property. Their principal business was the exchange of Roman for foreign coin, and the keeping of sums of money for other persons, which were deposited with or without interest, according to agreement. They acted as agents for the sale of estates, and a part of their duty was to test the genuineness of coin, and, in later times, to circulate it from the mint among the people. Lending money at a profit was also part of their business. It is supposed that among the Romans there was a higher and a lower class of argentarii. The more respectable of them probably held the position of the banker of modern times; while those who did business on a paltry scale, or degraded themselves by usury, were not held in any esteem. Their shops, being public property, were built under the inspection of the Censors, and by them were let to the argentarii. Trapezitae, as they are here called, was properly the Greek name for these persons, who were so styled from the trapesa, or table, at which they sat. All will remember the tables of the money-changers mentioned in the New Testament. The mensarii were employed to lend out the public money to borrowers at interest.

[53] I was security for : Spondeo, I promise, was a term used on many occasions among the Romans, derived from the Greek spendomai, pour out a libation; the usual mode of ratifying a treaty. Among others, it was pronounced by a person when he became security that another should repay money, as Lesbonicus, to his misfortune, had done in the present instance.

[54] Say, rather : Stasimus will not allow his master to mince the matter in the slightest degree. Don’t say I was security for it, but I paid it down.

[55] You used to say : He probably alludes to some former occasion, on which his master, having been duped into the belief, was telling him of the extraordinary wealth of his new acquaintance.

[56] With his savings : Peculium was the property amassed by a slave out of his savings, which he was permitted to keep as his own. According to the strictness of the law, the peculium was the property of the master. Sometimes it was agreed that the slave should purchase his freedom with his peculium when it amounted to a certain sum.

[57] I am a man : This is somewhat like the celebrated line in Terence: Homo sum, humani nihil alienum a me puto, I am a man, nothing that is human do I think unbecoming to me.

[58] Friend in need : Ferentarius, The ferentarii were the light-armed troops, who, being unencumbered with heavy armour, were ready to come immediately and opportunely to the assistance of those who were in danger of being

overpowered by the army. The word is here used figuratively, to signify a friend in need.

[59] And go hang yourself : The word dierecte is supposed to come from an obsolete verb, dierigo, to extend out on both sides, and to allude to a punishment inflicted upon slaves, when they were fastened to a stake in the ground, with the arms and legs extended. Applied to a slave, it would be an opprobrious expression, equivalent to go and be hanged.

[60] Be forbidding me : He means, that if he should take his master at his word and go away, he would be the first to stop him.

[61] Both to act : -2. The exact meaning of these lines is somewhat obscure. Thornton’s translation is: Or in word Or deed to play the trifler would ill suit One of my years.

[62] The one-eyed man : He means that he is determined to speak out at all risks, even if his master should be as good as his word, and tear his eye out.

[63] As your neighbour : Par here means a close neighbour, as reclining next to him on the same triclinium, or couch, at the entertainment.

[64] Style a public one : It is not certain what kind of public banquets are here referred to. Public entertainments were given to the people on the occasion of any public rejoicing: such, for instance, as a triumph, as we learn from Suetonius in his life of Julius Caesar. They were also given when the tenths were paid to Hercules. The clients, also, of the Patricians were in the habit of giving entertainments to their patrons on festival days, when each client contributed his share in kind; and numerous invitations were given, abundance and hospitality being the order of the day. Sometimes these feasts were held in a temple, and perhaps they are here referred to. There were also frequent entertainments in the Curiae, or Court-houses of Rome , at which the curiales, or men of the curia, or ward, met together.

[65] There the decision : Scaliger supposes that Stasimus is making a parody on the transaction of business by the Senate, who were said to give their decisions on matters sacred and human; and that he means to say that the feast is his Senate-house, and the food are the things sacred and human which he is bound to discuss, without respect for anybody.

[66] Without incumbrances : Every Roman family of consequence was bound to perform particular sacrifices, which were not only ordained by the pontifical laws, but the obligation was also rendered hereditary by the civil law, and ordered to be observed by the law of the Twelve Tables: Sacra privata perpetua manento, Let private sacrifices remain perpetual. This law is quoted and commented upon by Cicero in his Second Book on the Laws. He there tells us that heirs are obliged to continue their sacrifices, be they ever so expensive; and for this reason, as by the above law these sacrifices were to be maintained, no one was presumed to be better able to supply the place of the deceased person than his heir. A property exempt from this necessity, might be truly said to be one without incumbrances.

[67] The salt-cellar : By this expression, Plautus seems to mean that life is to the body as salt is to flesh; it preserves it from corruption.

[68] At Acheron : Acheron was a river of the Brutii in Campania . There was another river of this name in Epirus . The word usually denotes one of the rivers of Hell; here it means the Infernal regions themselves.

[69] As your name imports : The meaning of Stasimus is— Perhaps when you are dead, in leaving your property to another, you may really prove yourself the amiable man your name would bespeak you to be; Philto being derived from the Greek thileo, to love.

[70] I agree : Spondeo was a word in general use to denote that the person entered into a promise or engagement. Being the nearest male relation of the damsel, Philto wishes Lesbonicus to close the matter by saying spondeo, I agree to betroth her, which he hesitates to do; on which, Stasimus, alluding to his having been the security for the thousand drachmae, tells him that he had been ready enough to say spondeo when it was not to his advantage; namely, at the time when he aid spondeo, I promise, and became the security to the banker for his friend. See Note 1 in page 24.

[71] Part of line 525 in the Latin.

[72] Backgammoned state : Ad incitas redactus, brought to a standstill, was a term borrowed from the game of Duodecim Scripta, or twelve points, and was applied when one of the parties got all his men on the twelfth point, and, being able to move no further, lost the game in consequence. Probably the game partook of the nature of both backgammon and chess.

[73] The hogs die : From Pliny the Elder we learn that angina, or swelling of the throat, was a common distemper among hogs.

[74] The Syrian natives : He makes mention of the Syrians, because living in a hot climate, they would be most likely to be able to endure extreme heat.

[75] The solstitial fever : He seems to mean, that if a person went to live there at the beginning of the year, he could not possibly live there beyond six months, being sure to die of fever at the time of the Solstice, or Midsummer.

[76] I believe, Stasimus : Philto only says so for peace sake, as no man in his senses was likely to believe a word of it. As he does not want the piece of land for his son, he wishes to make no words about it.

[77] But the Campanian : He just makes this remark casually, probably to show Stasimus that he knows about things in general as well as he does. Some think, however, that he intends to correct Stasimus, and to tell him that even the Campanians, who were considered an effeminate race, could boast of more hardihood than the Syrians.

[78] To impose upon : Os quoi sublinat —literally, can besmear his face. This expression alludes to the practical joke of making a fool of a person by painting his face while he is asleep.

[79] I have cleverly frightened : As before remarked, he is probably much mistaken in thinking so.

[80] He is a man : His meaning seems to be, he is a man, with feelings like ourselves, and naturally wishes for his freedom,

[81] Do go now : Stasimus is continually urging him to follow Philto, and bring the matter to a conclusion, as he fears that so good an opportunity may be lost through his master’s habitual carelessness especially as Philto has agreed not to receive the land as a marriage-portion.

[82] ’Tis all over : He means that he will no longer have any support from his master, and that he will have to turn

soldier, and so earn his livelihood.

[83] Atia or to Cilicia : , Alluding, probably to the wars which were continually occurring between the Greeks and the Persian monarchs, or else to the custom of hiring themselves out as mercenary soldiers, as Xenophon and the ten thousand did to the younger Cyrus.

[84] Into a family so rich : In tantas divitias, literally, into so great wealth.

[85] This moment-like : Tammodo, He is joking upon the patois of the people of Praeneste, who said tammodo, instead of modo, this instant, or just now. Festus also alludes to this expression, as used by the Praenestines. In the Truculentus, act iii., sc. 2, l. 23, he again takes them off for catting Ciconia down to Conia. Praeeste was a town of Latium , not far from Rome . Its present name is Palestrina .

[86] Our son-i-law : He means Lysiteles, the contemplated son-in-law of his master Charmides, whom he has just been apostrophising.

[87] In the Courts of justice : It was the custom of the young men of the Patrician class among the Romans to plead gratuitously for their friends and clients, in the Forum or Court of justice.

[88] Set my seal : Affixing the seal to an instrument was then, as now the most solemn way of ratifying it.

[89] Charge of the balista : The word balista here signifies the charge of the military engine known as the balista. It was used by the ancients for the purpose of discharging stones against the higher part of the walls of besieged places, while the catapulta was directed against the lower. The charge of the balista varied from two pounds to three hundred-weight.

[90] Foolish and froward : Moros. This word is derived from the Greek moros, foolish. It seems to be used in juxtaposition with morosos, for the sake of the alliteration.

[91] Pleases him the least : So Shakspeare alludes to the contradictory nature of love in Romeo and Juliet: Love—heavy lightness! serious vanity! Misshapen chaos of well-seeming forms.

[92] Are now showing signs : The meaning of this passage is extremely obscure. Perhaps, however, it is this, If you persist in your extravagance, and are resolved to part with this land, the very last of your possessions, you will prove the conflagration and ruin of your family. Then you will be seeking a remedy—water with which to quench it. When you have got this remedy, as you cleverly suppose, in going abroad to fight and earn glory, you will ply it with such zeal, that you will overdo it, and, in getting killed yourself, will thereby quench the last spark on which the very existence of your house depended. Or this Lesbonicus says, though not carrying on the metaphor in the same sense, I will find means, even amid the enemy, to render my name illustrious, for there the fire may be found which is to keep my family from becoming extinguished.

[93] Rather in concubinage : His pride is hurt at the idea of his sister being married without a portion, and thereby losing one of the distinctive marks between a wife and a mistress. It was considered a disgraceful thing for a female to be given in marriage without a portion, however small.

[94] Do you suppose : Lysiteles says, satirically, and rather unkindly, it would seem, What, do you suppose that, if I accept this piece of land of you, you will attain the Dictatorship as the reward of your high spirit? The Dictatorshiip was the highest honour in the Roman Republic.

[95] Encore : Palin. This Greek word was no doubt used by the Romans just as we employ the French word encore. In a similar manner it was probably used in the theatres, the usage of which is here figuratively referred to.

[96] Composes better lines : In the line before, he alludes to the contest of the Comic poets for the prize of Comedy, to be decided according to the merits of their respective plays. As the poets were often the actors of their plays, he addresses them in this line in the latter capacity. Then, in the next line, he refers to the custom of the Romans in early times of training slaves as actors, where, if they did not please the spectators, they were taken off the stage and fined or beaten for their carelessness.

[97] On my back : When marching, the clypeus, or shield, was slung on the back of the soldier. The sarcina, or baggage, probably resembled our knapsack.

[98] Soles to be fastened : The soccus was a slipper or low shoe, which did not fit closely, and was not fastened by a tie. These were worn both by men and women, and especially by Comic actors. His meaning probably is, that he will be obliged to have high heels and thick soles put to his shoes, so as to turn them into caligae, the heavy kind of shoes worn by the Roman soldiers.

[99] Into the pay : In saginam, means for his food; as what we technically call the mess was provided for the soldier by those who hired him The term sagina is found especially applied to the victuals of the gladiators, who were trained up and dieted on all kinds of nourishing food for the purpose of adding to their strength, and thereby heightening interest attendant on their combats.

[100] Prove a brave : In this line and the next he is witty upon the sorry figure which he fancies Lesbonicus will make in the field of battle.

[101] Ask that talent : Many a truth is said in jest, and perhaps part of this talent is the fruit of the theft which he seems in joke only to admit in l. 414; as some Commentators have remarked, where was Stasimus, a slave, to get so much money as a talent, more than 200 £? As, however, in other respects, he seems to have been a faithful servant, let us in charity suppose that he cams honestly by his talent, and that it was his fairly acquired peculium

[102] His father’s signet : The custom of wearing rings among the Romans was said to have been derived from the Sabines. The stones set in them were generally engraved with some design, and they were universally used by both Greeks and Romans for the purpose of a seal. So common was the practice among the Greeks, that Solon made a very wholesome law which forbade engravers to keep the form of a seal which they had sold. In some rings the seal was cut in the metal itself. The designs engraved on rings were various; sometimes portraits of ancestors or friends, and sometimes subjects connected with the mythology or the worship of the Gods. The onyx was the stone most frequently used in rings. The genuineness of a letter was tested, not by the signature, but by the seal appended to it; hence the anxiety of Callicles on the present occasion.

[103] The custom-house officers : The portitores were the officers who collected the portorium, or import duty, on goods brought from foreign countries. These portitores, to whom it was frequently farmed, greatly annoyed the merchants by their unfair conduct and arbitrary proceedings. At Rome, all commodities, including slaves, which were imported for the purpose of selling again, were subject to the portorium. The present instance is an illustration of the license of their proceedings, for we can hardly suppose that they were entitled as of right to break open the seals of letters from foreign countries.

[104] A sharper : Sycophanta. At an early period there was a law at Athens against the exportation of figs. In spite,

however, of prohibitions and penalties; the fig-growers persisted in exporting the fruit. To inform the authorities against the practice was deemed mean and vexatious, so the statute came in time to be looked upon as obsolete. Hence, the term dukophanteun, to inform relative to the exportation of figs, came to be applied to all mean and dishonest accusations. In time, the word sycophant came to be applied to a man who was a cunning and villanous character, and who, as it has been justly observed, in Dr Smith's Dictionary, was a happy compound of the common barretor, informer, pettifogger, busybody, rogue, liar, and slanderer. In fact, he was such a person as we mean by the epithet swindler or sharper. Information being encouraged by the policy of Athens, and the informer gaining half the reward, it was upon this honourable calling that the sycophantae in general thrived They were ready, however, for any other job, however dishonorable, and perjury would not be declined by them if they could obtain their price. They would, consequently be much in the neighbourhood of the Courts of justice; and the Forum, as in the present instance, would not be an unlikely place to meet with them.

[105] But who is this : It seems at first sight rather absurd that Charmides, who has just returned from a voyage, should wait in the street to gossip with a stranger who is coming towards him; but we must remember that he sees that the fellow is making straight for his house, and his curiosity is excited by that fact, combined with the very extraordinary dress which Megaronides has hired for him from the playhouse, and has thereby probably much overdone the character which he is intended to represent.

[106] With his top : The Sharper, as personating a foreigner, has on a petasus, or hat with very wide brims, extending straight out on each side. For this reason Charmides wittily compares him to a mushroom—all head. The causia was a similar hat worn by the Macedonians, with the brims turned up at the sides.

[107] The theatrical wardrobe : Chorego —literally, from the Choregus. It was the duty of this person at Athens to provide the Choruses for tragedies and comedies, the Lyric Choruses of men and boys, the dancers for the Pyrrhic dance, the Cyclic Choruses, and the Choruses of flute-players for the religious festivals of Athens. He also had to provide the Chorus with the requisite dresses, wreaths, and masks—whence the application to him on the present occasion.

[108] A night-robber : Dormitator seems to mean a thief, who slept during the day and pursued his avocations by night. Sector zonarius is a cutter of girdles, similar to our cutpurse. It was the custom of persons of the middle and lower classes to wear their purses suspended from the zona, or girdle, round the waist; and sometimes they used the folds of the girdle itself for the purpose of depositing their money therein.

[109] Care of this door : It was not the usage to enter a house without giving notice to those within. This was done among the Spartans by shouting, while the Athenians, and other nations, either used the knocker of the door or rapped with the knuckles or a stick. In the houses of the rich a porter was always in attendance to open the door. He was commonly a slave or eunuch, and was, among the Romans, chained to his post. A dog was also in general chained near the entrance, and the warning, Cave canem, Beware of the dog, was sometimes written near the door.

[110] Respected sir : Pater, literally. father.

[111] To the Censor : Juratori. It was the duty of the Censor, among the Romans, to make these inquiries of every person when taking the Census. As the Censors were bound by an oath to the faithful discharge of their duties they were, in common with all persons so bound, called juratores, oathsmen. The Sharper gives Charmides an impudent answer, saying that he has answered the Censor on these points, and that is enough.

[112] Beginning of my name : He probably alludes to his varied calling, commensurate with everything in the line of roguery. See the Note to line 815.

[113] Size of a wine cask : He alludes, probably, to the amphora, or large earthen jar, in which wine was kept. This was, perhaps, a cant saying, just as if we should say, As little as a hogshead.

[114] Hush, that is my name : Pax. This word was used to enjoin silence, like our word Hush, or Whist. He seems to allude to his own thieving avocation, which often required him to be as mute as a mouse. Some of the editions nave tax, as though from tango, to prig, or steal. This, Thornton renders Touchit.

[115] Just as though : This passage is of obscure signification. A note of exclamation ought to be inserted after pax, and then the meaning of the old man seems to be, that, as in conversation a stop is instantly put to the discourse on saying hush! so, if anything is entrusted to him, it is as easily done for (periisse), and that it vanishes the instant you call him by his name. Thin is the explanation given by Lindemann. Ritschel reads pax, but most of the old Commentators have tax, which seems the more probable reading. The passage is thus rendered in Thornton's translation: SHARP. 'Tis Touchit;—that, sir, is my name. A common one. CHARM. A very knavish name: As though you meant to say if anything Was trusted to you, touch it, and 'tis gone.

[116] Isn't it the fact : He alludes to his having forgotten the confounded name, which was on the very tip of his tongue.

[117] At Rhadama : Rhadama is a fictitious name—pure gibberish. Cercopia is a preferable reading to Cecropia, which was an epithet of Athens, itself supposed to be the scene of the Comedy. The other word would imply some unknown region, called Apeland, as the Sharper's only aim is to impose upon the credulity of Charmides, and to hinder him from asking unseasonable questions. He coins the word upon the spur of the moment, though there really were the Ape Islands, or the isles of Pithecusae, off the coast of Campania. They are mentioned by Ovid, in the 14th book of the Metamorphoses, l. 291: For the father of the Gods, once abhorring the frauds and perjuries of the Cercropians, and the crimes of the fraudulent race, changed these men into ugly animals; that these same beings might be able to appear unlike men and yet like them. He both contracted their limbs and flattened their noses, bent back from their foreheads; and he furrowed their faces with the wrinkles of old age; and he sent them into this spot with the whole of their bodies covered with long yellow hair. Moreover, he first took away from them the use of language and of their tongues, made for dreadful perjury; he only allowed them to be able to complain with a harsh jabbering.

[118] Part of line 930 in the Latin.

[119] Land of Arabia : He gets out of depth directly he leaves imaginary places and touches on real countries. He makes Arabia to be in Pontus, while they were realy about two thousand miles asunder

[120] Wormwood grows : If he really refers here to Pontus. he accidentally hits upon the truth. Ovid, when in banishment there, says, in the Tristia, B. v. El. 13, l. 21, Let the white wormwood first be wanting in the freezing Pontus. The Sharper tries to correct himself by saying he means another Arabia, and not the one generally known, where the frankincense grows.

[121] In a little skiff : Horiola, or horia, was a small skiff or smack used by fishermen.

[122] No decent person : He is supposed covertly to allude to the disgraceful story at Ganymede being carried off by the eagle to minister to the lust of Jupiter.

[123] For I carry : He takes the other to be as great a rogue as himself and means, that his being Charmides only

depended on whether he himself admitted that he was in possession of the gold of Charmides.

[124] Yes, in writing : This, of course, was the fact, as Megaronides and Callicles would know better than entrust the fellow with any money. It probably means that he was entrusted with a letter to Callicles, enclosing a counterfeit bill at sight, or order on the Athenian bankers for payment of a thousand Philippeans to Callicles. This, Callicles was to show to Lesbonicus, to put him off the scent as to the treasure whence the money really was taken. The Sharper has told Charmides that he has the money with him, merely by way of boasting of his trustworthy character.

[125] At my own award : He means to tell Charmides, that by delaying his return thus late, he has spoilt his prospect of a lucrative job; and he then adds, that he deserves a thrashing, equally with the actor who came on the stage too late. The actors in early times, being often slaves, were liable to punishment if they offended the audience. The Aediles were the officers under whose superintendence the plays were performed; and probably with them lay the decision whether the actor should be punished for coming late on the stage, after he had been pronounced deserving of it in the opinion (arbitratus) of the spectators. See the Note to l. 707.

[126] Have arrived in safety : Advenis. After this word, Callicles might suppose that the Sharper is going to congratulate him in the usual terms on his safe arrival; but, instead of that, the fellow pauses, and then finishes with a malediction.

[127] Go and carry word : To tell him that he has given the three pieces to no purpose, for the real Charmides has made his appearance, and has completely spoiled the plot.

[128] From abroad : This scene is replete with true comic spirst It has been supposed by some that the disgrace of the pedant in Shakspeare’s Taming of the Shrew, and his assuming the name and character of Vincentio, were suggested by this scene. A similar incident is met with in the old play of Albumazar act iv., sc. 3. and most probably it was borrowed from the present passage.

[129] I’ faith, a bell : He aptly compares the worthless fellow to a bell, and then shrewdly judges that a bell cannot ring unless it is put in motion by somebody.

[130] For your shoulder-blades : The slaves among the Romans were whipped most unmercifully with the flagellum, a whip, to the handle of which a lash was fastened, made of cords or thongs of leather, especially from the ox’s hide. It was often knotted with bones, or pieces of bronze, or terminated by hooks, and was then not inaptly termed a scorpion. The infliction of punishment with this on the naked back was sometimes fatal, and was carried into execution by a class of slaves who were called lorarii.

[131] Smacks of the bull’s-hide : Cottabus was a game played by the Sicilians and Greeks, in which the players had in turn to throw wine out of a goblet into a metal basin at a certain distance, in such a way as not to spill any of the wine. The methods in which the game was played are stated with precision in an able article in Dr. Smith’s Dictionary. As one of the merits of the game was that the wine thrown should in its fall produce the strongest and most pat sound, Stasimus here calls the smacks of the whip on his back so many bubuli cottabi , ox-hide smacks.

[132] Forgotten your ring : We learn from Caelius Rhodiginus that condalium was a peculiar kind of ring worn by slaves.

[133] At the liquor-shop : The thermopolia are supposed to have been the same as the popinae, shops where drinks and ready-dressed provisions were sold. They were very numerous throughout Italy. The keepers of them were

called popae. In the present instance we learn what kind of people visited them, and Cicero tells us that they were frequented by the slaves and the lower orders. They sat on stools or benches, while they drank calda, or calida, mulled wine, which was always kept hot. It was probably mixed with spices, and was the favourite drink of the lower classes. It was measured out in poteria, draughts, which are here mentioned; and which formed, probably, about a moderate cupful. Claudius commanded the thermopolia to be closed at one period of his reign.

[134] His throat is his taskmaster : He has overheard what Stasimus has said about warming his throat in l. 1014; and, talking to himself, he remarks that his throat will be the cause of his learning how to run, as he warms his throat, gets drunk, loses his ring, runs homeward, and then runs back to find it.

[135] Would keep their hands off : There is no doubt that this is intended to be said satirically.

[136] Cricolabus, Collabus : These are either nicknames, or, possibly, names really given to slaves, as in all ages and countries masters have especially tried to show their wit in naming their slaves.

[137] Whipped-necks : Collicrepidae and Cruricrepidae were probably cant terms for slaves, who carried the marks of punishment on their necks and legs. Crepidae is from the verb crepo, to crack, and alludes to the sound of the lashes. Ferriterius was a slave who bore the marks of the chain with which he had been fastened for refractory conduct, while mastigia was a name given to a slave who had passed the ordeal of flogging. A liquor-shop was a likely place for the resort of worthless and refractory slaves.

[138] From a running footman : Cursores were slaves who ran before the carriage of their masters for the same purpose as our outriders. Perhaps, however, this is not the meaning of the word here, as the name was given to all slaves whom their masters employed in carrying letters and messages. Stasimus hints by this that his boon companions were not only very expert at thieving, but that they would prey inst as readily on a fellow-slave as any other person.

[139] Tack about, then : Cape vorsoriam was a sea-phrase, meaning ’turn, or tack about; as vorsoria was the name of the rope by which the sail was turned from one direction to another

[140] Parents to their children : This is said satirically in reference to the corruptness of the age, in which all the relations and duties of life were turned upside down.

[141] Are even hung up : He alludes to the custom among the Romans of writing or engraving the laws and ordinances on wood or brass, and hanging them up for public inspection upon pegs or rails in the Capitol, Forum, and Curiae, or Court-houses.

[142] If you lend : Stasimus has experienced this, and has applied for the talent which he lent, but in vain; unless, indeed, his meaning is that he got back the talent, but lost his friend. Shakspeare has a somewhat similar passage in Hamlet: Neither a borrower nor a lender be; For loan oft loseth both itself and friend.

[143] Do you set down : Appone. This word is used figuratively, it being employed to mean, in mercantile matters, to set down to one’s account. So Horace says: Quem sors dierum cumque dabit, lucro Appone— Whatever lot each day shall bring, set that down as clear gain. This, we may here observe, is a similar sentiment to that conveyed in the remark of Callicles, L. 65.

[144] Should be sprinkled : His meaning is, you should have beer as ready to give your assistance at the time when my fortunes were in their death- struggle through the conduct of my son Lesbonicus.

[145] Safe and sound : The lines after this, enclosed in brackets, are supplied by Ritschel in Latin verse, to supply the lacuna here, where it is clear that some part of the play has been lost. They are cleverly composed, and do great credit to his ingenuity.

[146] But what means : As he has been interrupted while digging up the treasure, it is probable that he has run out with his sleeves tucked up. and perhaps with the spade in his hand, which causes Charmides to make the present inquiry.

[147] The Piraeus : — The Piraeus was the main harbour of Athens, with which it was connected by long walls.

[148] Been already paid : — Among the Romans, merchandise which a person brought with him from abroad for his own use was in general exempt from portorium, or import duty; but this was not the case if it belonged rather to the luxuries than the necessaries of life.

[149] Part of line 1108 in the Latin.

[150] This individual : — He is speaking of himself in the third person, and is congratulating himself on his being about to obtain the hand of the daughter of Charmides.

[151] And demand it of me : — On the supposition of his father’s death, the laws would probably have decreed it to him as his father’s heir.

[152] The tunic is nearer : — This was, perhaps, a proverbial saying, used when a preference was expressed. Of course he would pay more respect to his anticipated father-in-law than to an ordinary friend. The tumca supplied the place of the shirt of modern times.

[153] If, father, any trouble : — Lesbonicus seems to be about to apologise to Charmides for any trouble he may have given him, but, as the old man has already agreed to forgive him at the intercession of Lysiteles, he will not allow a word more to be said about it.

[154] One misery : — The old gentleman tells his son that he will be quite sufficiently punished for his faults by having one wife. It is either said as a joke in a bantering way, or else it means, that, what will be a great punishment to him, he must now reform his mode of life, for common decency sake and out of respect to his wife.

[155] Give your applause : — Plaudite . Literally, clap your hands. Ritschel, on a full examination of the MSS., comes to the conclusion that this was said, not, as is generally thought by one of the characters in the play, but by one of the actors or singers, probably, of the Chorus, who commenced their song the moment the play was finished. All the applause bestowed on the writer and the actors seems to have been usually reserved for the end of the play.